

C.—COPTIC STUDIES, 1891-93.

[*The dialects of Coptic, notably the Boheiric of Northern Egypt, the Sahidic of Upper Egypt, and that of Middle Egypt were very strongly marked: at least three separate versions of the Scriptures existed in the different dialects.*—ED.]

BIBLICAL.

WE owe to the indefatigable members of the French "Mission" at Cairo the only Biblical texts published during the past two years. M. Maspero has printed¹ a large number of Sahidic fragments, acquired by the Bibliothèque Nationale from the apparently inexhaustible treasures of the "White Monastery." The texts range from Genesis to Tobit, and contain many passages not edited either by Ciasca or Amélineau. The only other publication of note is Dr. A. Schulte's comparison of the Greek and Coptic texts of the greater prophets.² The Coptic text here means merely the Boheiric version of Tattam; but the results obtained are often interesting, especially as regards the remarkable translation of Ezekiel, which is shown to have been decidedly influenced by a Latin version.

PATRISTIC.

The "Mission" gives further from the same source as the above-mentioned biblical texts, and of course also in Sahidic, some documents relative to the Council of Ephesus,³ and ascribed by their editor, M. Bouriant, to the 7th century at latest. The enigmatical figure of the monk, Victor, plays a prominent part here, as in the other Coptic texts relative to this Council. M. Bouriant publishes also two eulogiums upon the martyr Victor, son of Romanos, "a great general,"⁴ while Signor Rossi continues his publication of the Turin MSS. with a lengthy sermon of over eighty leaves upon death and future judgment.⁵ Dr. von Lemm has added another to his earlier instalment of the apocryphal fragments preserved at St. Petersburg, giving us this time texts from the martyrdoms of SS. Peter and Paul,⁶ of which the former could, it seems, be employed with advantage in criticising the corresponding Greek text. The versions coincide in part with those already printed by Guidi in his *Frammenti*. Dr. Carl Schmidt has translated, and Professor Harnack has commented upon, a valuable fragment of a Moses-Adam Apocalypse,⁷ resembling the Revelation of Moses published

by Tischendorf, but showing a distinct gnostic element in the remarkable list of names of angels which it exhibits.

GNOSTIC.

The most important additions made of late to Coptic literature are no doubt the works of M. Amélineau, Dr. C. Schmidt and Professor Harnack dealing with Egyptian Gnosticism. Since Schwartz's publication, some forty years ago, of the *Pistis Sophia*, several scholars have treated of the heresy of Valentinus, but for long no one ventured on the difficult task of publishing the other valuable texts which were known to be preserved in the Bodleian Library at Oxford. M. Amélineau was the first to undertake an edition of these papyri,⁸ brought home last century by Bruce, the African traveller. The publication did not give entire satisfaction, and was severely handled by Dr. Schmidt,⁹ who was himself preparing an edition of the *Codex Brucianus* for the *Texte und Untersuchungen*.¹⁰ The importance of these documents lies chiefly in their close connection with the system of the *Pistis*, whose peculiarities of dialect they also share, some portions of the Oxford texts having an even more decidedly Middle Egyptian character than the *Pistis*. The literature of the latter book too has been greatly enriched by the study of its contents made by Professor Harnack,¹¹ whose opinion is that the work emanates, not from the Valentinian, but from the Ophite school, though he admits that the system displayed is an "Ophitismus ohne Ophis." Professor Harnack also sees evidence that the *Pistis* is a product of Syrian Gnosticism, although there can be no doubt that the work, as we have it, was composed in Egypt.

VARIOUS.

Three more legal papyri from Jémé have been published by Dr. Steindorff,¹²—a deed of gift, a will, and a deed of sale, the last being yet another document relating to the affairs of that family of Germanos with which several others of these texts are concerned; it is written, moreover, by the already well-known hand of Johannes Lazaros. Dr. Steindorff has likewise printed¹³ an interesting letter from a bishop of Hermopolis, menacing with the Church's wrath those who had taken part in or connived at certain acts of burglary committed within his diocese.

As regards the language itself, a very elaborate and instructive study

of the pronunciation habitual at the present day among the native ecclesiastics in Upper Egypt, was made by the late M. de Rochemonteix,¹¹ who spared no pains in reproducing in print the linguistic peculiarities of two or three educated Copts, and whose work forms an interesting counterpart to the mediæval Coptic-French vocabulary published a few years ago by M. Maspero.

The class of documents known as "Faïyûm Papyri" forms the material of an admirable Guide to the Rainer Collections,¹⁵ for the Coptic portion of which Dr. Krall is responsible, and which is soon to be reissued in an enlarged edition. The MSS. catalogued are of very various natures; biblical and patristic fragments, legal texts and private letters, and range chronologically from præislamite times to the 9th or 10th centuries. The similar Coptic fragments from the collection of Professor Flinders Petrie have been edited by the present writer.¹⁶

The geography of Christian Egypt is treated in a new work by M. Amélineau,¹⁷ who has already dealt with some points of topography in the *Asiatic Quarterly*.¹⁸

Finally, Professor Ebers has turned his attention to Egyptian art of the Coptic period,¹⁹ numerous monuments of which were published not long ago by M. Gayet.

Beyond what has already been printed, we may look forward to the appearance of Dr. Steindorff's Grammar (*Porta Linguarum*), to the Rev. G. Horner's critical edition of the Boheiric Gospels, to a catalogue by Dr. Boeser of the Coptic MSS. at Leyden, and to the publication of some of those at Berlin in the new series of *Aegyptische Urkunden*.

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¹ Méms. de la Mission franç. au Caire, VI. i., ii.

² Die kopt. Uebersetzung der 4 gr. Propheten, 1892.

³ Méms. de la Mission franç., VIII. 1.

⁴ l.l. VIII. ii.

⁵ Memorie, Ser. II., t. xli.

⁶ Mélanges asiatiques, X. 2.

⁷ Sitzungsber. Berl. Akad. LI., LII. (1891).

⁸ In Notices et Extraits, XXIX. 1.

⁹ Gött. Gel. Anz. 1891, Nr. 17, 1892, Nr. 6. Cf. Rev. de l'hist. des Relig. XXIV. No. 3.

¹⁰ Bd. VIII. 1, 2.

¹¹ l.l. VII. 2.

¹² Zeitschr. f. äg. Spr. XXIX. 1.

¹³ l.l. XXX. 37.

¹⁴ Méms. de la Soc. de linguistique, VII.

¹⁵ Pap. Erz. Rainer, "Führer," I. Th.; Wien, 1892.

¹⁶ Coptic MSS. brought from the Fayûm; London, 1893.

¹⁷ Géogr. de l'Égypte à l'époque copte; Paris, 1893.

¹⁸ Second Ser. III. 6.

¹⁹ Sinnbildliches; eine Studie; Leipzig, 1892.

The following have been seen only since this article was written :—

- ²⁵ *Papyrus Grec inédit relatif à l'impôt sur les Pêcheurs* (a document apparently of the last half of the second century B.C.), published by E. Revillout in *Revue Egyptologique*, vii., 39 (1892).
- ²⁶ *Griechische Mumienetikette aus Ägypten*, by F. Krebs, in *Zeitschrift für Ägyptische Sprache*, vol. xxxii. (1894).
- ²⁷ *Ein altchristliches Mumienetikett, nebst Bemerkungen über das Begräbnisswesen der Kopten*, by Carl Schmidt, *ib.*

D.—COPTIC STUDIES.

[*Coptic literature has come down to us in five dialects: the Achmimic, Sahidic, Memphitic (or Lower Sahidic), Faiyumic and Boheiric. Of these, the second and the last are the most important. The Bashmuriac dialect has not survived.*]

BIBLICAL.

THE past twelve months have only seen the publication of two texts, both from the Old Testament. One is a Sahidic version of Job, which M. Amélineau prints¹ from MSS. at Rome and Naples: these are three in number, and date, we are told, from the 6th or 7th centuries, though the facsimile which Ciasca gives (vol. ii., tab. xxvi.) of one of them hardly supports a claim to such antiquity. It is not at all clear what use has been made of these several documents in detail. The words in which they are described (pp. 406, 407) are, to say the least, ambiguous. We must suppose the published text to result from a combination of the three MSS., which, by the way, are scarcely “complètement inédits,” seeing that the whole of chap. i. was printed from one of them by Tortoli in 1880. Tuki's faulty quotations from Job had another origin.

The other publication is a somewhat superfluous edition of the latter half of the Boheiric Psalter, printed by Prof. Rossi from a Turin MS.²

Mention should, in this connection, be made of the chapter dealing with the Coptic New Testament in the new edition of Scrivener,³ where Bp. Lightfoot's admirable and unique summary is brought up to date by Mr. Headlam. When Lightfoot wrote he could take account of three Coptic versions only—the Sahidic, the Boheiric and the “Bashmuriac.” We know now that there once existed at least four—the Achmimic

Sahidic, Memphitic (or, as Mr. Headlam prefers to call it, the Middle Egyptian), and Boheiric. Further investigation will be needed to prove that there really existed a Faiyumic version, distinct from the Memphitic. Among other interesting points we notice that Mr. Headlam claims for the Boheiric version an antiquity higher than that of the Sahidic, a new theory, not yet, at any rate, shared by other scholars.⁴

PATRISTIC.

On this side Coptic literature has been enriched by a large and well-printed volume,⁵ in which Dr. Budge edits three Boheiric Encomiums or discourses by Theodosius of Alexandria, Severus of Antioch, and Eustathius of Trake—the last an unidentified locality—in praise of St. Michael the Archangel. Linguistically the texts are not of more than the usual importance; but the comparative liveliness of the narratives, the novelty of several of the incidents, and the interesting lights frequently thrown upon Coptic civilization and superstitions, justify their publication. The Coptic versions are supplemented by specimens from their parallels in Arabic and Ethiopic, and the book closes with a useful index of the foreign words scattered through the texts.

To the same editor we owe a transcript and translation of the third work contained in that Zouche MS. from which he has already printed the martyrdom of St. Isaac, and a sermon of St. Ephraim. It is an Encomium on Elijah,⁶ attributed—probably falsely—to Chrysostom. The date of the MS., A.D. 1199, must give it a high rank among Boheiric documents.

M. Amélineau always the most industrious of editors, has printed,⁷ from Borgian MSS., the Boheiric lives of the founders of monachism in Lower Egypt, SS. Paul, Anthony, Macarius, John Kolobos and others, and has prefaced them with a lengthy introduction, in which he deals with the mutual relations of the various versions of their histories, arguing *inter alia* that the Coptic life of St. Paul was the basis of Jerome's Latin work.

Prof. Guidi has added to his earlier "Frammenti" another and final selection from the Sahidic MSS. in Rome and Naples. The documents are fragmentary, but often interesting, and relate to the martyrdom of Simon son of Cleophas, the death of St. John, and the Acts of SS. Paul and Barnabas. They likewise complete certain fragments of ecclesiastical anecdotes already edited in part by Zoega.

Prof. Rossi gives us, in the same publication as the Psalter mentioned above,⁸ portions of the martyria of SS. Theodore and Victor, as well as some interesting Gnostic texts of a magical character.

PHILOLOGICAL.

We have here the most important works of the year. Prof. Steindorff has at length produced his long-expected Grammar,⁹ while Prof. Atkinson of Dublin, known hitherto by his studies in Celtic philology, has found time to devote to the criticism of Coptic publications.¹⁰ The Grammar fulfils all expectations—and much was expected. It should not, perhaps, be discussed apart from its companion, Prof. Erman's Egyptian grammar. The two works mutually supplement and depend upon one another, and with their help it is now possible for students to begin that systematic study of the development of the language to which such concise and scientific guides are indispensable. Prof. Steindorff's book is divided into sections dealing with phonetic, formal and syntactical laws of the Sahidic dialect, that idiom being now recognized as a medium with better historical and literary claims than the formerly more fashionable Boheiric. The Introduction, treating of the sounds and sound-changes, will perhaps be found to contain the most that is new; more than one valuable phonetic rule is there for the first time discerned, and those previously realised are stated in terse and clear language. The Chrestomathy, following the Grammar, contains a selection chiefly of patristic texts, none of them of great difficulty, but all well calculated to give familiarity with the spirit of the language. Passages from Lagarde's "Wisdom," and from the "Pistis," are included as specimens of the oldest and purest Sahidic literature. The method of word-division employed will strike many as unfamiliar; but on consideration it fully approves itself. The principle upon which it is based is that defended ten years ago by Prof. Erman, viz., that we should not divide in print what in the language forms one whole. If exception were to be taken to any consequence of this doctrine, it would be to Prof. Steindorff's introduction of the hyphen where some might prefer to see the central and the dependent word printed together, as one undivided group. Those who would see the results of a wholly different conception of this much-vexed question should examine the word-division in Dr. Budge's "St. Michael." It may be remarked here in passing that excellent photographs of the famous Horoscope, which Prof. Steindorff speaks of (p. 3) as still unpublished, are to be found in Mr. Kenyon's new Catalogue.¹¹

The criticisms of Prof. Atkinson deal with certain of the Turin MSS. as edited by Prof. Rossi, and with M. Bouriant's Eulogy on S. Victor. It hardly needed demonstrations so lengthy to prove the inferior quality of either the Italian or the French publication; but those who have the

perseverance to wade through Prof. Atkinson's 135 pp. will find plenty there that is instructive and not a little that is amusing. That some such awakening was very much needed, and that it has come none too soon, is but too undeniably shown by Prof. Atkinson's criticisms, which it is to be hoped will prove a warning and a terror to all future editors of Coptic texts. The successful use should be noticed which the writer has made of the ordinary Roman type in the reproduction of Coptic words; it is similar, though not identical with the transcription used by Lagarde for his Psalter.

MISCELLANEOUS.

One of the most valuable publications of the last few years has been that of M. Amélineau's geographical dictionary,¹² referred to in our last Report. It forms a sequel to the great work of Brugsch, and deals therefore only with the topography of Christian Egypt. In compiling it M. Amélineau has made use of Arabic and Greek documents, as well as of the Coptic texts themselves, though it must be owned that all sources have not been exhausted. The MS. collections in Berlin and St. Petersburg have not been drawn upon, and very small use, if any, has been made of the British Museum papyri—Goodwin's list, *Aeg. Zeits.* 1869, being apparently ignored. One of the most interesting sections of the book is the appendix, in which two valuable lists are transcribed (in Coptic and Arabic, and often with Greek equivalents) of the mediæval Egyptian bishoprics, so many of which have long ceased to exist. Among many other interesting questions, M. Amélineau incidentally discusses (p. 34) the exact uses of the native and Arabic terms for an episcopal see and the relation of this to the civil divisions of the country. The hieroglyphic equivalents, chosen for comparison with the Coptic names, do not, at first sight, look very satisfactory. It appears, however, that the clumsiness of the forms—that, *e.g.* of Abydos, p. 155—is due to the base epochs to which M. Amélineau has thought it best to confine his selection. The value of the work is greatly increased by its excellent indices.

As regards the group of legal documents known as the "Jémé Papyri," two small publications have appeared, of which the first is an article by Dr. H. O. Lange of Copenhagen,¹³ dealing with the joint will of the monks Jacob and Elias. Dr. Lange gives a new translation of the text (No. 3 in Revillout), with a commentary on some of the questions involved—the status of the testators, the topography of the monastery

and the succession of its abbots; and he also translates passages from the unpublished papyrus No. 78 of the British Museum. The second publication is that by M. Loret¹⁴ of a fragment of a similar testament, remarkable as being dated in the 24th year of Constans II. (*i.e.* A.D. 665) and also as bearing an unusually lengthy Greek protocol, before the Coptic text.

Nothing further has been published relative to the "Faiyum Papyri," the new edition of the Rainer "Guide" being, as regards the Coptic section, merely a reprint of the earlier catalogue.

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- ¹ Trans. Soc. Bibl. Arch., ix. 405.
- ² Mem. della R. Accad. di Torino, Ser. ii., T. xliii.
- ³ Introduction to the Criticism of the N. T., 4th ed., vol. ii., ch. iv.
- ⁴ Cf. Carl Schmidt in Theolog. Literaturz., 1893, p. 567.
- ⁵ Saint Michael the Archangel, London, 1894.
- ⁶ Trans. Soc. Bibl. Arch. ix., 355.
- ⁷ Ann. du Musée Guimet, T. 25, Paris, 1894.
- ⁸ *Vide* note 2 *supra*.
- ⁹ Koptische Grammatik (Porta Linguarum), Berlin, 1894.
- ¹⁰ Proc. R. Irish Acad., 3rd ser., vol. iii., p. 24, and *ib.*, p. 225.
- ¹¹ Catalogue of Greek Papyri in the Brit. Museum, pll. 73, 74.
- ¹² La Géographie de l'Égypte à l'époque copte, Paris, 1893.
- ¹³ En Thebansk Klosterforstanders Testamente. (I know this only as a "tirage-à-part," kindly sent by the author, and do not know from what journal it is extracted.)
- ¹⁴ Rec. de Travaux, &c., xvi. 103.

C.—COPTIC STUDIES.

DURING the past twelve months singularly few publications relating to Christian Egypt have appeared. The French Mission at Cairo seems to be devoting its energies chiefly to the monuments of earlier epochs. Signor Rossi has declared that the Turin papyri have been finally exhausted by the interesting texts which he gave us last year, and official duties at the Propaganda still delay the longed-for continuation of Msgr. Ciasca's *Fragmenta*. Even M. Amélineau, hitherto by far the most active editor in the field, has refrained from printing the quarto volume that we had grown used to expect.

Indeed, there seem to be only three books to call, this year, for our attention. But the importance of one at any rate of them is a compensation for such apparent inactivity. Professor Krall, whose competence to take advantage of his unique opportunities has been amply demonstrated in his contributions to the *Mittheilungen* of the great Rainer collection, has at length brought out an instalment of the long-promised *Corpus*.¹ This volume contains all those "legal" documents—to use the most comprehensive term—in which the Vienna collection is so extraordinarily rich. Indeed, no other European museum—with the possible exception of the Louvre, where a considerable number of similar papyri were probably acquired within recent times—can at all compare its treasures in this particular with those in Vienna. Professor Krall reckons in all 4000 Coptic documents, of which about 220 are classed as legal, and published here. These consist of deeds of sale, acknowledgments of debt, receipts for payment, guarantees, leases, loans, statements of wages, deeds of gift, agreements as to choice of arbitrators, as well as various lists of places, and proper names, accounts, and so forth. Even the numerous unidentifiable fragments are not omitted, and their inclusion is well justified by the number of interesting points which can be collected from a careful study of them.

Accustomed as we are to look to the monasteries of 'Abd al-Kurnah for all information on the legal circumstances of Coptic life, this unexpected crowd of fresh material is as surprising as it is welcome. Professor Krall has been frequently able to illustrate his new documents by parallel passages from the published Jémé papyri. None, of course, of

¹ *Corpus Papyrorum Raineri*, vol. ii. *Koptische Texte* herausgegeben von J. Krall; I. Band—Rechtsurkunden. Wien, 1895.

the former can be compared for length to even the shorter of these latter texts; instead of extending to 200 lines, no continuous text in the new publication has more than 40. In collections such as that in Professor Krall's hands, the task of assigning each piece to its exact dialect is a very difficult one. We are given a table at the end of the volume, from which we can judge of the decisions to which the editor has come, and we see that the division has been made almost equally, only a small majority of the texts being classed as Sa'idic. In one fragment indeed (*no.* cxvi.) we see an example of what may almost be regarded as a new dialect; though a recollection of the amazing laxity in the orthography of almost all Middle-Egyptian texts must make us hesitate to assign too much weight to the evidence of a single mutilated papyrus. We can but look forward eagerly to the succeeding volumes of the *Corpus*, which are to give us the strictly literary texts, and, before all, that priceless Akhmîmic MS. of the Lesser Prophets, of which a specimen facsimile has already appeared in the Rainer *Führer*.

The second work which we have to notice is due to a native of Egypt. Claudius Johannes Labîb, professor in the college of the Coptic clergy at Cairo, has published two small volumes of a Coptic Grammar, for the use of his compatriots, and written, of course, in Arabic, under the patronage of the reigning Patriarch, Cyrill the Fifth.¹ The author, in his preface, states that he "has examined the books upon this language composed by Europeans, in order to find a new method, and a succinct and profitable course which might simplify the difficulties" hitherto encountered in teaching. The authorities referred to range from Young and Champollion to Stern, and the constant citations show that their works have been profitably studied. Nor have the older grammarians, such as Ibn 'Assâl, Ibn Zahîri (as he is here always called), and Ibn Kâtib Kaîsar, been neglected. Professor Labîb's work is a considerable advance upon the somewhat unmethodical primer of his predecessor, Barsûm Effendi Râhib, from whom he nevertheless quotes here and there. Indeed, this is, so far as I know, the first attempt that has been made in Egypt to teach native students their ancient language upon Western methods, and it ranks, therefore, beside the hieroglyphic publications of Kamâl Effendi. The grammar is arranged upon the plan familiar to us, and proceeds, from chapters upon the article, substantive and pronoun, to the conjugation of verbs and

¹ *Kitâb ad-durûs an-nahwiyyah fy ma'rifat al-lugat al-Kubtiyyah al-Mi'riyyah* &c. Bi-Miṣr al-Kâhirah, A.M. 1610 (= A.D. 1894).

the enumeration of adverbs and other particles. The actual requirements of the priesthood, and the example of preceding writers have secured for the Bohairic (*i.e.* the Alexandrine) dialect almost a monopoly of the illustrative examples, although the author professes to draw also upon the Sa'idic and Fayyûmic. In the second volume, the rules are interspersed with reading lessons taken from Budge's "Isaak of Tiphre." A third part, dealing with the syntax, is presumably to follow later on.

The work which it remains to speak of has only an indirect claim to a notice here. Mr. Evetts has edited, for the Oxford series of *Anecdota*, the "Tarîkh ash-shaikh Abî Şâlih," and given a translation under the title of "The Churches and Monasteries of Egypt," while Mr. A. J. Butler, probably the best living authority on the subject, has supplemented the translation with exhaustive notes.¹ The references so often made to Abu Şelah (as he used to be called) by Quatremère, were of themselves sufficient to make all those interested in mediæval Egypt desirous of seeing the text published. Now that we have before us this excellent edition, expectations may perhaps be somewhat disappointed; for neither are the available MSS. complete, nor, if they were, would they give us more than a mediocre abridgment of the original composition. Internal evidence points to the opening years of the XIIIth century as the date of Abu Şâlih's work, so that it was possible for him to make use of the chronicles of Severus of Eshmûnain and others who had recorded the history of the Christians and their Patriarchs. But when will an editor be found for Severus himself? MSS. of his work and of that of his continuators are to be found in several libraries; and yet, since Renaudot's time, no one has thought it worth while to print the text which that scholar made the basis of his history. A very welcome appendix to Mr. Evetts's edition is the fresh translation of the corresponding portions of Makrîzî's "Khitat," of which work a full translation is now in course of publication by M. Bouriant.

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P.S.—M. Amélineau has not disappointed us. Since this notice was sent to press, announcements have appeared of two works by him; (1) a volume of miscellaneous patristic texts (*Méms. de la Miss. au Caire*) and (2) a notice of certain biblical MSS. in the Bibliothèque Nationale (Paris; Klincksieck).

¹ *Anecdota Oroniensia; The Churches and Monasteries of Egypt*, by B. T. A. Evetts and A. J. Butler. Oxford, 1895.

¹⁹ *Proceedings of the Society of Biblical Archaeology*, xviii. 107-109.

²⁰ *Ib.*, p. 54.

²¹ *Zu den Zauberpapyri*, in *Philologus*, liv. 560 (1895).

²² *L'Egitto dei Greci e dei Romani*, 2a edizione riveduta dall' autore, ed accresciuta di un' appendice bibliografica sui progressi della Egittologia Greco-Romana dal 1868 al 1895: by Giacomo Lumbroso. (Roma, 1895.)

²³ *Gita Papirologica a Oxford e Dublino*, in *Rendiconti della R. Accademia dei Lincei*. (June, 1896.)

C.—COPTIC STUDIES.

1. *Biblical and Apocryphal*. Dr. A. Schulte has during the past year published the continuation to his previous critical studies on the Coptic—or more exactly, the Bohairic—version of the Old Testament.¹ He has examined the texts of the Minor Prophets printed by Tattam, as contrasted with the Greek of the *Cod. Vaticanus*, and has in several cases been thus enabled to suggest emendations of the latter text. He has found the Bohairic version to be on the whole accurate, without any slavish imitation of the Greek text from which it was made, and which he holds to be itself lost, though related to one of the extant groups. Dr. Schulte gives useful lists of the different classes of divergencies between the versions, and also of the Greek words to be found in the Coptic text. It seems a pity that use should not have now been made of the various, often considerable, remnants of the Sa'idic version of these books published by Ciasca and Maspero since the appearance of Dr. Schulte's earlier work.

The title of the short, descriptive paper which has appeared in the *Notices et Extraits*,² might lead one to expect a work of greater extent than that which M. Amélineau has given us, and which turns out to be an elaborate description of some half-dozen fragments of the New Testament from the enormous collection procured for the Paris library from Akhmîm. These fragments are chiefly of interest from the fact of their containing not only the Sa'idic, but also the parallel Greek passages. The latter should of themselves attract attention, since so very little is known, and still less has been printed, of Greek texts from such sources. M. Amélineau's description of the MSS. themselves are most exhaustive, and deal minutely with palaeographical questions. Among the first words in the paper is the announcement that the author has already catalogued the whole collection—an achievement which we trust will be followed by its early publication.

The Rev. H. Goussen, of Strassburg, has rendered a service to all New Testament students by his publication, as the first volume of a somewhat formidable series—"omnium N. Test. versionum orientalium editiones historicasque criticas"—of the Sa'idic text of the Apocalypse.³ Some passages in this version had already been edited elsewhere, but it is here for the first time printed from a very fine and interesting MS., preserved partly in Berlin, partly in London. This MS. is of very great age, and though the version exhibited is not one of any remarkable individuality, the text itself is of great philological interest. The Coptic text is compared throughout—in a manner somewhat perfunctory and superficial—with the Greek of Westcott-Hort. The editor takes occasion to make an attack in passing upon those who would see in the Bohairic version the influence of "Western readings,"—an attack directed presumably against a writer in the last edition of "Scrivener."

Prof. Hyvernat, who has published so little of late years, begins in the *Revue Biblique*⁴ a series of papers on the Coptic versions of the Bible which, to judge from the opening number treating of the dialects, promise to be clearly written and helpful to the public for which they are intended.

The Rev. Forbes Robinson is the editor, in the Cambridge *Texts and Studies*,⁵ of a very valuable collection of all the known texts, whether printed or in MS., relating to the lives of our Lord and His parents, and giving either different accounts of facts to be found in the canonical gospels or telling of events which these do not mention. Not all the fragments contained in the volume can be exactly regarded as belonging to actual "apocrypha." Some of them are merely passages incidentally occurring in sermons; though Mr. Robinson did indeed meet with several sermons which contained versions of gospel narratives so much elaborated as to be almost "apocryphal." A remarkable fact in connection with these texts is that, unlike most of the apocrypha otherwise known, some of them appear to deal with the period of Christ's ministry. Mr. Robinson has given the first English translations of the texts (published by Lagarde) of the "Falling asleep of Mary" and the "Death of Joseph," and also the texts of several interesting Sa'idic fragments which he has been at great pains in copying and collating in Italy and elsewhere. In printing the Coptic texts it has been the editor's aim to reproduce exactly the punctuation, accentuation, &c., of his originals. He has adopted Stern's method of word-division in preference to that of Erman, and has, in his preliminary descriptions, given very useful details regarding the ornamentation of the various MSS., which will

undoubtedly be of service in identifying and classifying others in the future.

One of the most interesting publications of the year is also one of the least voluminous. A short paper, read to the Berlin Academy by Dr. Carl Schmidt,⁶ announces the discovery, among the inexhaustible treasures from Akhmîm, of some sixteen leaves from a papyrus book the contents of which Dr. Schmidt seems to have good grounds for assigning to an orthodox and not a gnostic writer, although one's first impression would probably be in favour of the latter ascription. The work apparently relates conversations held by our Lord with His disciples, who afterwards committed them to writing for the benefit of the faithful. They are not without resemblance to the Petrine apocrypha (likewise discovered at Akhmîm), and may be dated, according to Dr. Schmidt, in the first half of the second century. All will be anxious to see this valuable text speedily published, the more so since it is written in the rare and ancient dialect of Akhmîm.

2. *Patristic.* The large volume which is M. Amélineau's latest addition to the publications of the French "*Mission*,"⁷ is dated 1893, yet it saw the light only last year. The valuable texts here made accessible are a further result of the discovery of the *débris* of the library of the White Monastery, which may be said to have supplied us with practically all the Sa'idic literature now in Europe. They form a continuation of the same indefatigable editor's former collection (the life of Shenoute), and comprise a variety of fragments from Lives and Acts of various Coptic Saints, ranging from the 4th to the 7th centuries. There are many points of interest to which attention might be called; the most interesting perhaps is the statement in the introduction, and already made elsewhere by the author, that one of the fragments transcribed can be dated to the years immediately after the Persian invasion of the 7th century. But an examination of the MS. in question makes it very doubtful whether that conclusion can be drawn from the obscure and faded colophon on which this weighty statement is based. The script, too, of the text itself is far more closely allied to that of the dated MSS. of the 10th and 11th centuries than to anything we have reason to assign to an earlier period. While grateful to M. Amélineau for all the documents he has here and elsewhere brought within our reach, we shall be still more in his debt when he fulfils the promise he incidentally makes in this volume, to edit all that remain of the writings of the most remarkable of Egyptian saints—Shenoute.

Dr. von Lemm continues his successful endeavours to identify the

Coptic original of Severus of Ashmunâin.⁸ He had satisfactorily demonstrated the fact of the existence of such a work some years ago. The latest volume of Rossi's Turin papyri has, with its large collection of small detached fragments, given him fresh opportunities for exercising his skill and acuteness. He has managed to piece together, out of some apparently hopeless remains, not inconsiderable passages from the Encomium on Athanasius, of which he had already identified portions in his previous publication.

Dr. Grützmacher, of Freiburg, from his previous studies of Benedict of Nursia, is well fitted to examine the documents on which our knowledge of the earliest monasticism—that of Pachomius in Egypt—is based.⁹ His book is practically an abstract and criticism of the Coptic and Arabic texts published by M. Amélineau (*Musée Guimet* xvii.), from whose conclusions he does not often differ much. The Sa'idic version of the Life of the saint is of course judged to be the original, and to be represented pretty accurately by the Arabic; the Bohairic, and through it the Greek forms of the story, likewise are derived from the Sa'idic. The author combats Weingarten's well-known theory of the Serapian origin of Christian monasticism, though he admits that the existence of such heathen communities would have a strong influence upon the early ascetics. Many interesting phases of the movement are well thrown into relief; for example, the speedy hostility of the secular clergy to the Pachomian foundations, and the rapidity with which the latter were imitated—no less than ten communities observing the Pachomian rule being established between Esneh and Hermopolis in the course of a few years.

3. *Gnostic and Magical.* The Berlin Museum has not been without its share of the treasures which of late years have been brought to light in the Faiyûm, and besides publishing the texts of some thirty of the papyri,¹⁰ Professor Erman has given us admirable translations of one group of them¹¹ which he recognizes as the stock-in-trade of a magician. There are amulets and charms in great variety—love charms, charms against sleeplessness, charms to loosen chains, besides medical prescriptions, directions for dying, and the like. The most remarkable, no doubt, are those which show a strange confusion of heathen and Christian ideas, telling now a story of Isis and Horus, now one of Christ and Mary. The texts themselves are often of great interest, written generally in an archaic idiom, and in a dialect which might be termed with equal accuracy Sa'idic or Middle Egyptian. They have preserved several very interesting and otherwise, no doubt, obsolete words, the

meanings of which the editor has happily traced to their hieroglyphic prototypes. Professor Erman has also edited a curious text (*φυλακτήριον*) from the British Museum¹² of which Professor Hyvernat had previously published a photograph, and which appears to have the object of enabling those who wish it—thieves, no doubt—to silence a too zealous watchdog. The document claims to be written by Isis, and contains examples of a well-known cryptographic system. Under the title "*Heidnisches bei den Kopten*," the same scholar notices¹³ three points of interest—an obscure mention in one of Shenoute's writings of certain classical divinities, the eventual degradation of the old Egyptian word for "god" in Christian times to the meaning "demon," and a text relating a very curious story of Isis and Horus.

A notice in the *Revue Critique* shows that M. Amélineau has published a translation of the "Pistis Sophia";¹⁴ but I have not been able to see the work.

The most remarkable event in this branch of Egyptian studies is only known to us as yet from a notice in a daily paper.¹⁵ Dr. Carl Schmidt had communicated to the Berlin Academy his astonishing discovery of a 5th century (*sic?*) MS. of the greatest importance containing three Gnostic texts, viz. "the Gospel of Mary," "the Wisdom of Jesus," and "the *πράξις* of Peter." The existence of the first of these had already been presumed from the testimony of Irenæus.

4. *Philological*. Professor Erman has given an explanation of the auxiliary *meshe-*, *meshak*, &c.,¹⁶ which he proposes to add to the very small list of verbs which represent the old simple conjugation with suffix.

Professor Piehl in two papers¹⁷ discusses (1) the prefix *se-*, which he derives from the ancient *st*; and (2), the mode of expressing the numeral 80, which he shows to be a compound meaning literally 4×20 , as demonstrated by a passage in the "Pistis Sophia."

A reprint of Peyron's *Lexicon* has appeared in Berlin¹⁸ with the useful addition of the lists contributed to the *Zeitschrift* by Goodwin, Kabis and Bschiai. These twenty pages added to Peyron's work will help, no doubt, in maintaining its position until the appearance of Dr. Steindorff's dictionary.

5. *Miscellaneous*. In his edition of the Ethiopic "Physiologus" Hommel showed the probability of a Coptic version, and now Professor Erman has discovered¹⁹ a remnant of it in a fragment of late date which may be compared with the passages quoted from the same work in Budge's "St. Michael." The passages preserved in the Berlin fragment are not always easy of interpretation. They refer to the bird

named Alloe, identified by Professor Erman with the Arabic *samandal*, or salamander. It is clear, at any rate, that this Coptic version differed widely from the other oriental versions.

W. E. CRUM.

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C.—CHRISTIAN EGYPT.*

1. *Biblical*.—Fragments of the Sa'idic Pentateuch, in the Paris collection, but omitted in Maspero's publication, are printed by BROOKE.¹

WESSELY, who hitherto had not concerned himself with the Coptic portion of the Rainer collection, now elaborately edits its Psalter fragments (already arranged by Krall).² The most important are the 'early 6th century' papyrus, photographed in the *Führer*, and a still older piece, with parallel Greek text. Fragments from 9 vellum MSS. are also published, 2 being bilingual and, W. holds, of the 5th century—if so, the oldest bilingual extant.

The Egyptian Psalter versions take a prominent place in RAHLFS's important study of that book.³ The result of his investigation is that the whole evidence, text and versions together, indicates three groups: the Egyptian (Upper and Lower), the Western, and the Common. The Upper Egyptian is represented by the Sa'idic and the London (U) and Leipzig papyri; the Lower by *Codex B* and the Bohairic. The Sa'idic and Bohairic influenced each other at various periods, though of course the latter is far younger. Cyril clearly favours the Lower Egyptian type, which should imply that this represents the Hesychian recension; while much earlier Fathers testify to the antiquity of the Upper Egyptian version, which is indeed apparently preorigenistic. Many of its peculiarities are arbitrary and independent of the Greek: some even postchristian (Heinrici).

The Hesychian type of text is evidently represented, according to DEISSMANN, by the Heidelberg fragment of the Prophets, which he recently edited and which he describes as the remnant of a Bible from an Upper Egyptian village church.⁴

Crum's *Ostraca* and some published by Lefébvre (*v. Report* 1904-05, 73), contain a number of Greek New Testament texts, which BLUDAU critically re-edits.⁵ L.'s series, with Luke xxii, he, like Lefébvre, takes to represent a poor man's lectionary.

In LEIPOLDT'S 'History of the New Testament Canon'⁶ there are, as might be expected, much information and many interesting suggestions regarding the history of the Bible in Egypt, especially as to the use there of the older apocryphal books. We may note his observations on the probable Egyptian origin of 2 Clement, also of the *Codex Sinaiticus* and the *Catal. Claromontanus*; on the popularity there of Hermas, though no longer canonically accepted; on the influence of Shenoute in securing the

* I have, as usual, to thank Professor L. Scherman for some references.

reception of the Revelation; on Shenoute's own apocalypse; on the failure of Origenism to check the taste in Egypt for these works; on the gradual acquiescence of the later Gnostics in the church.

A note on page 82 of this book shows that L. is further the author of the *Church Quarterly* article, mentioned in last *Report*, 66.

The vast introduction preliminary to VON SODEN's edition of the Greek New Testament^{6a} naturally contains much relating to the Egyptian text (Hesychius, Origen), to that used by the Alexandrine fathers and to the interrelation of these and the Coptic versions (*v. e.g.* pp. 903, ff., 1472, ff., 1480). The section on the last is supplied by LEIPOLDT and gives a useful description of those linguistic peculiarities to be disregarded in appealing to their testimony; also an elaborate collation, showing the most characteristic Hesychian readings in the Coptic.

2. *Apocryphal, Gnostic, &c.*—Another important text has been acquired by the Berlin Museum (*v. last Report*, 67). C. SCHMIDT describes⁷ and will—it is to be hoped, before long—publish a papyrus giving an ancient Achmîmic version of 1 Clement (entitled 'The Epistle of the Romans to the Corinthians'), which we could infer from Eusebius to have been canonical in Egypt. S. dates the MS. in the latter part of the 4th century. The underlying Greek text appears to have been of sound but ordinary type; the Psalter used was that of Upper Egypt. It is significant that the 2nd Epistle is here still absent. The idiom is interesting and shows several strange words.

Further fragments of the Sa'idic Hermas are published by DELAPORTE, from the same MS. as before (*v. last Report*, 67).⁸

WINSTEDT prints and translates five Paris leaves (129¹⁸, 116 ff.) of an apocryphal story narrated by James, the Lord's brother, and relating to John the Baptist.⁹ The Apostles visit the seven heavens, the third of which is assigned to the Baptist, who is to act the part of a sort of Charon.

Under the heading 'New Sayings of Christ' is announced¹⁰ the acquisition at Edfu by R. DE RUSTAFJÄLL, of a number of Coptic and Greek MSS. The above title was applied to a considerable fragment which had indeed already been identified as belonging to the 'Revelation of Bartholomew,' whereof other fragments had been long known. The text is partly identical with that printed by Lacau (*Méms. de l'Institut. franç.* ix, 39). See also no. 40 below.

Reviews of C. Schmidt's translation of the *Pistis* are given by BARDENHEWER and K. LAKE.¹¹

3. *Liturgical.*—DELAPORTE describes¹² a version of the Bohairic Conse-

eration service for monks, which somewhat differs from that printed by Evetts.

LEIPOLDT has found and prints a complete text of the Bohairic hymn to Shenoute, Brit. Mus. *Catal.* no. 901.¹³ He points out the claims of such hymns to notice, as probably the only original Bohairic compositions, translated neither from Greek nor Sa'idic. Could the same be said of the *Theotokia*?

Among the Arabic hymns to Christ and the Virgin, published by ASIN Y PALACIOS,¹⁴ are some of doubtful origin. The words *mârî* and *murta*, though primarily Syrian, would not, in such a composition, militate against an Egyptian origin. But the list of saints in the final hymn distinctly points to Syria.

The new volume of KENYON and BELL'S Papyrus Catalogue¹⁵ closes with two ill-written hymns of the 6th century, addressed to the Trinity and the Virgin respectively. Their phraseology is very obscure.

A Greek papyrus fragment at Jena contains what may be an amulet in the form of a prayer. It is edited by LIETZMANN.¹⁶

4. *Church Literature*.—For many years it has been known that AMÉLINEAU contemplated a full edition of Shenoute. The first instalment of this has at length appeared and deserves a longer appreciation than can be given here.¹⁷ An introduction of 112 pp., wherein much is said in self-defence and a good deal in criticism of others, describes his ideas as to palaeographical *criteria* in general, the features of the MSS. edited in particular, and the peculiarities and difficulties of Shenoute's style. Much, possibly excessive, stress is laid upon exact superlineation, though the texts printed wholly omit it. These 5 texts are Zoega's nos. 184–188, with additional pieces from Paris and Oxford. Where Zoega has omitted passages, A. has copied the originals; otherwise he has collated. Zoega's no. 185, fol. 1, he still prints as Shenoute's (*v. J. Th. Stud.* v, 130), and regards the whole as from one MS. It would seem, from his notes on *σχολάζειν* and *(h)ετάζειν* and from the various unidentified quotations, as if the work had been done under somewhat inadequate conditions. The translation reads well; but I have not compared it with the Coptic. There are 5 good plates.

GORE gives notes¹⁸ on the Homilies of Macarius the Egyptian, whence he has extracted *data*, historical and doctrinal, showing them to be at any rate by a desert Father of the 4th century; nor does he see any objection to their traditional ascription to Macarius.

MERCATI shows¹⁹ that a supposed collection of Letters by the same Macarius, in a Paris MS., is in reality to be assigned to St. Nilus.

The same scholar also points out²⁰ that a Coptic homily bearing the name of Eusebius (Brit. Mus. no. 171) is nothing but a version of one otherwise ascribed to Chrysostom (*P.G.* 52, 449).

And he demonstrates²¹ the spuriousness of the supposed Athanasian tract *De Azymis* (*P.G.* 26, 1338).

In view of the forthcoming publication in the *Patrologia Orientalis* of the Coptic remains of the works of Severus of Antioch, PORCHER, who has undertaken that task, gives a preliminary notice to those of Paris.²² It may be observed that, among his MSS., the 1st is to be joined to the leaves Cairo 8010, the 5th to Brit. Mus. no. 185, the 7th to Brit. Mus. no. 190.

A Greek text of the *Apophthegmata* has long been desired and NAU's contribution towards it will be welcomed. He gives, merely as a preliminary, the text of one MS., forming a sequel to Cotelier's edition; but he also describes several others.²³

Some of the pieces in Horner's *Statutes* were claimed as Hippolytan by von der Goltz (*v. last Report*, 68). Such high antiquity FUNK disputes.²⁴ He regards them as not older than the rest.

Neither can DREWS accept them as Hippolytan²⁵—that they were so would indeed be a notable proof of early Roman influence on Alexandria. The value of the Ethiopic baptismal office lies in the fresh material contributed towards the evolution of the Egyptian rite.

E. C. BUTLER analyses Funk's final edition of the *Didascalia* and *Constitutions* (1906), accepting his proposed genealogy of the documents.²⁶

The already published 'Refutation' of Sa'id b. Batrik (Eutychius) by Severus of Ashmunain (*v. last Report*, 69) is analysed by LEROY,²⁷ who is about to edit the same author's 'History of the Councils,' which he likewise describes.

It is announced²⁸ that the Berlin Museum has acquired (from the same place as the above Epistle of Clement), a 7 metre long papyrus, with the Festal Letter of an 8th century patriarch, in Greek.

5. *History, Legends, &c.*—WESSELY has republished²⁹ in one volume a number of the oldest papyrus texts relating specifically to Christian affairs. The 1st section consists of documents of the Decian persecution, the 2nd of letters (including that of Psenosiris, which W. regards from Deissmann's standpoint), the 3rd of fragments of the canonical scriptures, the 4th of the *Logia*, the 5th of extracts from the chief magical papyri (one hitherto unpublished), the 6th of miscellaneous literary fragments.

As a preliminary to his edition of Shenoute's writings, LEIPOLDT has republished³⁰ the Bohairic *Life*, after a collation of Amélineau's print with

the original. He adds various small texts relating to Shenoute. The Latin translation is to follow.

WINSTEDT continues his publication³¹ of the Sa'idic papyri in Munich, and gives fragments of the Ignatian Epistles and of the Martyrdom of SS. Peter and Paul, with an otherwise unknown passage relating to Paul's baptism of a certain Dionysius (? the Areopagite).

BALESTRI prints³² a further instalment of the Martyrdom of Theodore the Eastern (*v. last Report*, 71, where the text was erroneously called Sa'idic).

The need, now made real by Kaufmann's excavations, of a monograph on St. Menas has been, to a great extent, satisfied by Miss MURRAY's account of the facts, legendary and material, hitherto known.³³ She wrote before the results of the recent excavations were available; yet she had observed that the miraculous cures were effected by means of water, perhaps from some medicinal source. She has collected the historical notices of the great church, enumerates the scattered inscriptions and evidence for the cult, and describes, with the help of good plates, the different types of flasks.

The legend of St. Catherine of Alexandria has little Egyptian in it beyond the scene of the martyrdom. An Arabic rendering, published by PEETERS,³⁴ contributes something towards the classification of the earlier versions.

Two monks of Egyptian birth and training, Isaiah and Barsanuphius (properly *Wershenoufe*), were conspicuous among the ascetes in southern Palestine, at the close of the 5th and beginning of the 6th centuries respectively. The former appears as a monophysite of so mild a variety, that his writings have always been accepted by the catholics; the latter, though he had a monophysite namesake in Egypt at the time, was himself orthodox. Both ascetes and their works are studied by VAILHÉ.³⁵

One of the latest worthies to be given a place in the Coptic calendar was Baršaumâ 'the Naked,' a wonderworking *fakîr*, who lived and in 1317 died at Old Cairo. His Arabic *Life* and miracles, and what remains of the Coptic original (?), are published by CRUM, who also gives some details as to another Cairene saint, Ruwaîs.³⁶

A second part of FORGET's text of the *Synaxarium* has appeared,³⁷ extending from the 6th of Kihak to the end of Emshîr.

N. GIRON, who had supplied Revillout with certain of the texts for his *Apocryphes*, now himself publishes others of his copies.³⁸ No. 1 is apparently from a homily, here treating of the Fall. It should, I think, belong to Paris 131¹, 41 ff., which is a sermon of Chrysostom upon Michael and Satan. No. 2 shows a discourse of Chrysostom. This is proved by

the final words, where Traké, the supposed place of his exile (*v. Brit. Mus. Catal.*, nos. 307, 983) is the scene of action. Its historical value may be judged from the term 'Chalcedonian' applied to one of the saint's enemies. Possibly this is from the same MS. as Paris 132¹, 14, 15, which appear to be likewise from a *Life*. No. 3 gives the texts relating to St. Marina, already published by Hyvernât (*v. Report* 1901-02, 51). No. 4 consists of the already published fragments regarding Zeno's daughters, but with some interesting additions from Paris. No. 5 is merely a reprint of Zoega no. clxvii. The accompanying translations appear to be adequate.

Another text from the interesting Nitrian cycle in which the emperor's daughters appear is that relating to the 49 monks massacred by the barbarians (*v. Synaxarium*, 26th Tube). DE RICCI has studied the Bohairic text (Zoega, p. 95) and will, it is hoped, publish it.³⁹

The MSS. acquired by R. DE RUSTAFJÄLL (*v. no. 10 above*) comprize, besides New Testament texts, the Miracles of SS. Cosmas and Damianus in Greek—too late, unfortunately, for Deubner's edition—a Sermon by Cyril of Jerusalem on the Cross, one by Pisenthius of Coptos (*v. Crum, Ostraca*, no. 25), and the Martyrdom of St. Mercurius, whereof as yet no Coptic text has been available. The *Illustrated London News*⁴⁰ has some palaeographically valuable photographs of the MSS., some of which are dated.

A history of the various patriarchates under Turkish rule has been written by S. SIDAROÛSS, a catholic Copt of western training.⁴¹ The Latin patriarchate of Alexandria (residence: Rome), the Copts proper, whose doctrinal proximity to the catholics is emphasized, the catholic Copts, the orthodox Greeks (Melkites), the protestant missions, are successively described at length; also their several relations to the civil government; the efforts of the Copts since 1873 at secularizing their ecclesiastical authority and the like efforts of the catholics; the actual legal status of the Egyptian communities—all these subjects are treated with considerable knowledge and constant citation of authorities.

A large undertaking has been commenced by A. RABBATH, who has published⁴² the first parts of a collection of documents, ecclesiastical and civil, illustrative of the relations of eastern catholics with the papacy, since the 16th century. The main source is the reports of consuls and missionaries in the Paris libraries and Jesuit archives. Regarding Egypt are 120 pages relating to the first (Jesuit) mission to the Copts, begun in 1561.

The same writer prints⁴³ a further letter of Gabriel VIII, addressed to certain of his clergy, and probably of the year 1613.

Since Stern's masterly sketch of Coptic literature, twenty years ago, no

general view of the subject has been attempted, and LEIPOLDT's contribution to the *Litteraturen des Ostens* will be welcomed.⁴⁴ In 50 pages he gives an admirable account of the rise and decline of what was pre-eminently 'a literature of immediate needs,' called into being through the rapid conversion of an illiterate peasantry to the new religion. Hence the uncouth translations, the simple nature of the works translated. The chronological sequence of the literary dialects is shown—Achmîmic, Sa'idic, Bohairic—and the moulding influence of Shenoute, even upon the Bible text of his day. Unusual attention is paid to the popular poetry (hymns), which in the later periods seems the only conspicuous form of literature. (I learn that a special study of these metrical compositions will shortly be published by H. JUNKER.) The poverty of secular works is ascribed to the constant lack of political security and quiet. Bohairic literature L. regards as a purely post-moslim product, of which we should scarcely have heard, had it not chanced to be in the idiom of the patriarchs. There are indeed some unsolved problems still in the history of this dialect. How comes it that of it alone no trace survives of common, daily use—no letters, documents? Are climatic conditions an adequate explanation?

6. *Non-literary Texts*.—GUIDI publishes⁴⁵ a stele of A.D. 751 and an interesting ostrakon, illustrating the legal (?) formula, 'Here is God's word to thee,' &c. He also gives corrections, from the originals, to the texts in Mallon's *Chrestomathie*, with several valuable remarks, and reprints accurately the Middle Egyptian colophon, Zoega, p. 105.

PELLEGRINI prints⁴⁶ 17 short texts, mostly ostraca, from the Florence museum, correcting incidentally the readings of those included in Crum's *Ostraca*. One of them is a legal deed, on leather, from Jêmé, another an imprecation.

An article in Cabrol's Dictionary by LECLERCQ,⁴⁷ on 'Athanasius' in epigraphy, gives the well-known letter to monks from a Theban tomb and a few smaller inscriptions.

In the same work LEFÉBVRE gives an epigraphic account of 'Athribis.'⁴⁸

At Benha, the northern Athribis, LEFÉBVRE found a Greek epitaph, with some unusual formulae.⁴⁹

7. *Philology*.—The rapidity with which Steindorff's and MALLON's Coptic Grammars have reached second editions is a striking proof of the growing interest taken in the language. M. has now⁵⁰ separated his Sa'idic material—intended only as illustrative of the Bohairic—into an appendix. Profiting by Guidi's emendations, he has somewhat remodelled the chrestomathy and has further increased the already full bibliography. SPIEGELBERG has reviewed the first edition, with certain criticisms.⁵¹

MALLON prosecutes his interesting studies of the medieval grammarians⁶² (*v. last Report*, 74), occupying himself now with those of the 14th century: Abû Shâkir (otherwise Butrus b. Râhib, the chronicler) and Abû 'l-Barakât, the latter perhaps the most remarkable of all the group. The preface to the former's Grammar is translated and gives valuable information as to the mode in which such writers worked.

GARDINER gives⁵³ an instance of the verb *n'y*, used in a future sense foreshadowing the Coptic *na-*.

8. *Art, Archaeology, Excavations*.—Again the first place must be given to KAUFMANN'S work on the site of the Menas shrine.⁵⁴ The second Report, with many photographs, tells of further exploration in the 3 connected churches: the Arcadian basilica, the shrine chapel proper, and the baptistery—the latter the first met with in Egypt; but besides these, in the vast monastic buildings adjoining, which alone cover some 40,000 square metres. An excellent general plan by Falls shows the elaborate complexity of the ruins. A well or cistern, 80 metres long, brought the healing water to the shrine chapel and was flanked by baths. Further, four distinct cemeteries were traced; but the graves held nothing beyond the corpse and an occasional flask. The almost complete absence, so far, of inscriptions is indeed very remarkable. A few *graffiti* seem to point to about A.D. 500. There remains still work sufficient for several years to come; but funds are urgently needed. I would call attention to two points: that the flasks with *αγιου* (*sic*) *Αθηνουγενου* (pp. 53, 60) should be compared with the fragment at Alexandria (*v. Report* 1902-03, 61); and that the jar with X M Εμμανουηλ (p. 94) may support the reading 'Christ, Michael, Gabriel' for XMT.

STRZYGOWSKI, whose future collaboration Kaufmann has secured, reviews the new Report.⁵⁵ A more detailed criticism is that by BAUMSTARK,⁵⁶ who compares the basilica with S. Paolo 'fuori,' likewise dating from about 400. He sees in it already the chief characteristics of the Cairo churches. The baptistery he holds to be the oldest of the buildings. KAUFMANN had himself written a short, preliminary account of the work.⁵⁷

He has further announced⁵⁸ that, after the completion of the Menas excavations, he purposes to undertake a systematic, if not exhaustive, survey of all the still traceable Christian monuments—how many are perishing annually!—which enthusiasm for the earlier periods of history has too often caused to be neglected.

A belated report on work at Bawît in 1903 is given by PALANQUE.⁵⁹ His object was to ascertain whether two of the largest chapels were connected. They proved not to be so, though several of the smaller were joined. Many

of the latter class are but plain, square buildings with cupolas, resembling the modern tombs. Of the plates, no. iv probably shows 'Zacharias, the faithful priest,' in elaborate costume; no. xi a nun, 'the mother of the monastery.' On p. 7 is a dated inscription (Moslim era); on p. 11 the names of Job's comforters, and on p. 19 those of the prophets; p. 13, a painter had been brought from the Jeremias monastery (? at Sakḥārah); p. 18, the strange name 'Apa Samarites' again (v. Clédat, *Baouit* pl. xxix.).

In the past season PETRIE explored the ruins of two Coptic monasteries at Balaizah and Ganadlah, S.W. of Abutîg.⁶⁰ There are, he says, many such ruined sites in that district, each consisting of an ancient cave (the chapel), with partition walls, while additional buildings protrude outside. At the former site, a find of Coptic MSS. was made, whereof a description, by CRUM, may have appeared (in Petrie's 2nd volume) before this *Report* is published. From these and from incidental coins, it seems that the monastery, which was that of Apa Apollo, flourished till the 8th century; but many of the MSS. are far older. From them it has further been possible to identify the town *Sbēht* (now Kom Esfaht) with one of the ancient Lower (or Lesser) Apollinopolises. The plates of Petrie's first volume reproduce some interesting fragments of sculpture, a remarkable engraved (liturgical?) knife, a bronze hanging lamp, identical in form with those in enamelled glass of the 14th century, and 7 Coptic stelae, showing some rare place-names.

A small convent has been traced by BARSANTI,⁶¹ in ruins at Zawiyet el-'Aryân, S. of Gizeh.

GAYET has been again occupied at Antinoë; but it is difficult, from the only account available,⁶² to distinguish the results of this season's work. Three ruined monasteries, with surrounding cemeteries, are spoken of. But it is not clear that they were among the recent discoveries. The majority of the finds were pagan.

In the last *Report*, p. 73, Crum suggested that certain stelae indicated the site of the *Henaton*. BRECCIA has in consequence made investigations, but without finding anything conclusive, though enough to testify to Christian buildings.⁶³ The neighbouring names, *Kom ez-Zugâg* and *Kom el-Hanatûn*, however look significant.

QUIBELL describes⁶⁴ the frescoes in a small hewn chapel, in the cliff at Gurnah, presumably the resort of an anchorite.

QUIBELL is at present engaged upon the site of a monastery, near Sakḥārah, which, to judge from the incidental inscriptions, should be that—well-known, but hitherto unidentified—of Apa Jeremias, and in which

elaborately frescoed chapels have been found. Before long we may expect a full report on the excavation.

STEINDORFF gives a popular account⁶⁵ of a visit to the monastery of Macarius in Nitria. It appears that the brotherhood is now recruited by monks selected in Egypt and banished thither by the Patriarch.

The German National Museum at Nuremberg possesses a small collection (120 pieces) of 'Coptic' antiquities (acquired from Forrer). These are described⁶⁶ by O. PELKA on the lines of Strzygowski's Cairo catalogue, whose classifications however are occasionally disputed. P. ascribes the quantity and ubiquity of Menas flasks to a possible commercial export from Alexandria; and he suggests that the wooden bread-stamps were not only for sacramental, but also for everyday use. On the still unsettled eagle-dove question, see the instance cited in last *Report*, p. 75.

The Vatican stelae published by MUÑOS⁶⁷ (v. last *Report*, 74) are five in number. One shows the name *Pantoniké*; another, commemorating an *oeconomus*, is decorated with two curious spade-like instruments.

C. L. WOOLLEY discusses⁶⁸ the purpose of the small bone 'dolls' attributed to the Copts. He would regard them rather as for religious or superstitious usage. But are they certainly Christian? That distinguished by a Christian inscription scarcely seems to belong to the series.

Nor is the statue in niche, published by SOBHI EFFENDI ARIF,⁶⁹ in the usual Christian style. It recalls rather the provincial work of the latest Roman period.

9. *Miscellaneous*.—O. VON LEMM has begun a fresh series of *miscellanea*⁷⁰ with fifteen short notes, chiefly corrections or supplements to the publications of others, e.g. to Crum's *Brit. Mus. Catalogue*, where no. 262 is shown to be from Baruch, ch. iv.

That *Catalogue* is reviewed, with a number of important rectifications, by P. PEETERS.⁷¹

A dozen Copto-Arabic MSS. at the Catholic University, Beyrout, are described by CHEIKHO.⁷² No. 4 is a narrative (*risâlah*) of the Passion, from the Coptic, by Severus of Ashmunain. On the back of no. 2 is a list of books, including one which may be read *Atanâsiûs âurtastikât*, 'the Festal Letters of Athanasius,' witnessing to the existence of an Arabic translation, of which to-day nothing is known.

CLERMONT GANNEAU calls attention to the strange name given by Makrizi to the 12th Coptic month⁷³: *Abîkâ*. He takes it for a confusion with the corresponding Syrian *Ab*.

Until the appearance of a catalogue 'raisonné' of the Paris Coptic collection, CHABOT's publication⁷⁴ of the old summary list (1739), with

that now deposited in the 'Salle des Manuscrits,' will be of great service. It enumerates in all 153 MSS.

Last winter a sale was held of R. DE RUSTAFJÄLL'S Egyptian antiquities, and a catalogue with interesting plates issued.⁷⁵ Pl. ix shows a stele with two *orantes*, pll. xxi, xxiv a number of embroideries. Another stele was sold, whereon is commemorated a priest of the καθολική (v. *P.S.B.A.* xxvii, 171) of *Moondé*, i.e. Mehendi in Nubia.

The late Th. Bent held the not improbable opinion that the older Abyssinian churches would preserve, not only ancient Ethiopic, but also Coptic books. It may be noted that FLEMMING, who was the literary expert with the recent German mission, thinks all such hopes should be abandoned :⁷⁶ nothing of the sort is now to be met with, at any rate, above ground.

In so far as Nubian was but an offshoot of Coptic Christianity, we may here record the very important fact of MSS. in the Nubian language having at length come to light.⁷⁷ They show, according to SCHÄFER, already a specialist in matters Nubian, parts of a lectionary, differing at least from the Bohairic, and an apocryphal hymn in honour of the Cross, probably not earlier than the 5th century.

W. E. CRUM.

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POSTSCRIPT.

Prof. GARSTANG sends the following note:—

"We resumed our excavations at Abydos at Christmas and continued until the end of April. The first thing we discovered in the Valley leading to the tombs of the Kings was a necropolis of Graeco-Roman date. It was undisturbed and lay just under the surface. In this a great number of stelae of that period were discovered, some of them with Greek or Demotic inscriptions. The carvings upon them were an interesting link between the Egyptian and the Christian emblems. In other parts of the cemetery we continued to excavate in the tombs of the XIIth Dynasty, which, though they had been so much disturbed in the past, continued to yield up to patient work a number of small art treasures. Amongst these was the figure of a 'Puntite' woman carrying her baby, in wood, beautifully carved. There were several other statues in wood, and one of a private person in bronze in excellent condition. In another tomb of the same date a series of glazed objects were found; they included some unusually beautiful examples of the art, such as the figures of a hippopotamus, cynocephalus, dog, cat, panther, etc. With these were a number of vases and trinkets and a few fragments of pottery of the Kamares type and some dated XIIth Dyn. seals. These have been placed by arrangement in the Ashmolean Museum. We are going on with this work for several years, I hope, so that it is impossible to give a final summary."

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⁴² *New Palaeographical Society*, part vi (1908).
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⁴⁴ *Op. cit.*, part vii.: *Demotische und griechische Texte auf Mumientäfelchen* (Leipzig, 1908).
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C.—CHRISTIAN EGYPT.

1. *Biblical*.—WESSELY has recognized some further fragments of the Middle Egyptian MS. of the Epistles, whence Krall and Chassinat had edited certain passages (*v. Report* 1902-3, 52)¹. He doubts whether the text on Zoega, p. 151, is from this same MS. I have however a facsimile which proves this to be the case.

MALLON describes² a Bohairic Psalter of the 15th or 14th century which shows the usual liturgical additions (Odes).

The often discussed reference to 'Babylon' in 1 Peter v, 13 is interpreted by SALOMON REINACH³ as an indication of *Tendenz* in the writer—probably a Syrian forger, *ca.* A.D. 80—who was bent on showing Babylon (Old Cairo) to be an earlier Christian centre than Alexandria. Possibly too he would utilize thus the tradition of Peter as the teacher of Mark.

DEISSMANN'S new book,⁴ treating as it does primarily of biblical studies, may be mentioned here. It is mainly concerned (like many of the author's recent writings) in emphasising the importance of the non-literary materials made available by modern excavation and travel. The value of Egyptian papyri and ostraca are the theme of a great part of this highly interesting book. The principal texts described and commented are the

New Testament ostraca (*v. last Report* 67), which D. holds to be merely copies made by poor persons, unable to command better writing material; the 3d century Amherst Papyrus from Rome; the letter of Psenosiris and other Christian letters; various Coptic ostraca relating to church affairs (note the discussion here of *μανλίζω*, p. 155), and Pap. Oxyrh. ccix, regarded as an amulet. Reviewed by SCHÜRER,^{4a} who scarcely admits the high value put by D. upon his materials.

H. MÜLLER contributes a number of notes and bibliographical additions to Bludau's list of N. Test. papyrus fragments.⁵

The *provenance* of the famous uncial MSS., recently acquired by Mr. Freer, was at first uncertain. C. SCHMIDT declares⁶ that he has good grounds for tracing them to the White Monastery. Presumably then they belonged to an earlier deposit of books than the Coptic MSS. which have hitherto come in such numbers from that library. They should be due to the same source as the 'Elias Apocalypse,' the new Clement, and a few other early papyrus codices.

2. *Apocryphal, Gnostic*.—The interesting fragment of an uncanonical Gospel lately found by GRENFELL and HUNT⁷ has already been much discussed (*e.g.* by BÜCHLER, *Jew. Quart.* '08, 330, HARNACK, *Preuss. Jahrb.* '08, 201, SWETE in Lietzmann's *Kleine Texte*). The editors themselves take it to belong to a lost Gospel—not that of the Hebrews or Egyptians—composed in Egypt, probably before A.D. 200, while they date the MS. about the year 400. Heretical features are absent; its interest centres rather in the curious references to the temple and its ritual, very divergent in many points from that described in Jewish sources.

Taking as his text a passage in Irenaeus (*Adv. Haer.* i, 29) descriptive of the 'Barbelo' sect of gnostics, C. SCHMIDT gives⁸ a good deal of welcome information as to the important pre-Irenaeian Coptic text at Berlin, whereof we hope that he will, in time, give us an edition (*v. Report* 1895-6, 51). The proper title of the text should be 'The Apocryphon of John.' Its contents well illustrate the way in which gnostic thought in Egypt was influenced by pagan philosophy. A comparison of Irenaeus' brief abstracts from it show in general a conscientious adherence to the original. Its chief value lies in the power we hence, for the first time, gain of controlling the (hostile) description of a gnostic sect by an original document.

CRUM enumerates⁹ the works represented among the fragments—some of very early date—from Dair Balaizah. They include, besides biblical texts, a leaf from a lost gospel or apocalypse, and one apparently from the above mentioned 'Apocryphon of John.'

WINSTEDT edits¹⁰ fragments of an already known collection of brief lives in Coptic of the apostles and other biblical characters. In several cases legendary matter is conspicuous.

In GALTIER'S publication¹¹ of an account by A. des Rivières of Harris's MSS. (biblical and patristic), a fragment of 'the Gospel of Nicodemus or of the Egyptians' is mentioned. What has become of this?

ANDERSSON prints¹² further instalments of his criticisms, chiefly philological, on Amélineau's *Pistis*, taking account now of C. Schmidt's translation likewise.

PEETERS criticises¹³ Lüdtke's study of the Salome legend (*v. Report* 1905-06, 68).

LIEBLEIN suggests that the obscure ἀντίμιμον πνεῦμα of the *Pistis* is a reminiscence of the Egyptian *ka*.^{13a}

3. *Liturgical*.—The foremost contribution to this branch of our subject might be as well classed under 'Philology,' for it is equally important in that aspect. H. JUNKER has undertaken the investigation of what remains of Coptic poetry in the Sa'idic dialect.¹⁴ 'Of the 10th century,' he terms it, for the MSS. should indeed date roughly from that period. But its elements are doubtless to be sought far further back. J. describes all the known MSS., pointing out the 'dramatic' structure of some (recitative, solo, chorus), discusses the titles prescribing the melodies, the form of strophes, the rhythmical construction. He shows the freedom with which toned and untoned syllables can be interchanged, and how indefinite may be the number of the latter in a line. He examines the Byzantine element in the hymns, both as regards texts translated, or rather, adapted and melodies used. The debased linguistic character of all texts (the long Leyden MS. being the purest) would be the result of repeated copying; the originals would be in classical Sa'idic. The completion of JUNKER'S fundamental work is still to come.

One of the hymns in Kenyon and Bell's *Catalogue* iii (*v. last Report* 69) is reedited by P. MAAS,¹⁵ who regards it as possibly used as a model by Romanos. It bears a certain likeness to the *Te Deum* and is still to be heard in the Greek church.

JUNKER compares¹⁶ the hymn to the Cross in one of the new Nubian MSS., with a Sa'idic text in Leyden (*Manuscripts* p. 433), and draws the natural conclusion that, in such matters, Nubia was indebted to Egypt.

He also shows¹⁷ that the Sa'idic hymn, Berlin *Urkunden* i, p. 163, is the Greek ὕμνος ἐωθινός, in a longer form, and that it is to be found also in Bohairic (*Theotokia* &c.).

TURAEF prints¹⁸ a Bohairic 'canon' on the Virgin, Christmas &c. He

also points out the resemblance, important chronologically, between certain strophes in the *Theotokia* and a hymn attributed to John Damascene.

Further, he gives,¹⁹ in Bohairic and (with KRATSKOWSKI'S aid) Arabic, 2 *psalms* to Takla Haimânôt. On these PEETERS has some observations.²⁰ But it may be noted that being acrostical (alphabetical), these hymns can hardly but be of Coptic origin.

GALTIER minutely investigates a very interesting text²¹: a Bohairic *Theotokia* transcribed into Arabic letters. He compares the phonetic system thus exhibited with that recorded by De Rochemonteix. It may be questioned whether the grounds alleged, as evidence against the new text representing a *living* pronunciation, are conclusive (*e.g.* the transcription of *gima* and *shai*).

The curious ritual of Extreme Unction (*Kandil*), as practised to-day in Upper Egypt, appears to illustrate the intention of certain small lamps, with holes for seven wicks, which LEGRAIN describes.²²

A new edition has been issued²³ in Cairo of the 'Diurnal' or 'Seven Prayers,' called the *Agbiyah* (according to Mallon, the plur. of *ajep* 'hour'). Appended are certain prayers attributed to Ephrem Syrus.

The Balaizah fragments (v. no. 9 above) include an important passage (the *epiclesis* &c.), from a Greek anaphora, the MS. being of about the 7th century. It formed the subject of a paper by P. DE PUNIET at the recent Eucharistic Congress.

4. *Church Literature*.—One of the most valuable Coptic texts published of late years is the Achmîmic version of 1 Clement, which C. SCHMIDT has elaborately edited,²⁴ with a full glossary adequate to the linguistic importance of this very ancient and peculiar text, the MS. of which S. would date in the second half of the 4th century (the script I should rate somewhat later). The editor has some judicious and opportune remarks upon the unavoidable difficulties for textual criticism, due to the ambiguity or insufficiency of Coptic idiom, and he classifies into twelve main characteristics the constant features of the language which must militate against perfection in any rendering from a Greek original. Reviewed by LEIPOLDT.^{24a}

The figure of Origen has inevitably overshadowed those of his followers, three of whom—Theognostus, Pierius and Peter the Martyr—have been the subject of L. B. RADFORD'S studies.²⁵ The attitude of the first of the three, mainly an apologist, regarding Creation, Christology, the Trinity &c., is described. For an estimate of the second but little material remains. Peter, unlike the others, is distinctly anti-origenist. Certain of

the fragments attributed to him are shown to be in reality post-Nestorian. On p. 2 is a fresh discussion of the sequence of the teachers in the catechetical school.

In a study of Macarius the Egyptian, STOFFELS²⁶ points out the influence of the Stoic philosophy of nature on his mystical theology, although M. does not show any direct acquaintance with Greek thinkers. How he became familiar with their views remains obscure. His was the first mystical interpretation of Christianity, definitely formulated against pantheism. As to the authenticity of his works, the historical facts deduceable appear to fit a 4th century coenobite (not hermit) such as M., nearly contemporary with Augustine (*cf.* their doctrines of 'original sin'). He, rather than Dionysius the Areopagite, is the true first mystic: D. is the learned speculator, M. the practical ascetic. When Byzantine mysticism shall have been investigated, it may appear that M. was not without influence upon the 'hesychiasts' of Greece.

WINSTEDT's further instalment from the Munich MSS.²⁷ includes a fragment of an Epistle to Basil, ascribed to Chrysostom and relating to an apostate friend.

The 'Scholia on the Incarnation' of Cyril of Alexandria is but partly extant in Greek. CONYBEARE's edition of the 8th century Armenian version is therefore welcome.²⁸ No book better sums up the dogmatic contests and contrasts of the age of Nestorius; none was more popular with the monophysites. The same publication also gives us Cyril's otherwise unknown letter to Theodosius on Easter, which contains the statement that the writer had compiled a table of Easter dates upon the Diocletian era. JÜLICHER calls attention to the importance of this second text.²⁹

G. FICKER devotes a volume to Amphilochius of Iconium,³⁰ and includes therein a translation (by A. JACOBY) of the homily on the 'Sacrifice of Isaac,' preserved in Bohairic (*Vatic.* lxi), which he inclines to accept as authentic. JACOBY contemplates an edition of the text.

In a criticism of Amélineau's *Oeuvres de Shenoudi*,³¹ Nau takes occasion to review the whole question of the authenticity of the works usually attributed to that famous monk. Some pieces headed Σινουθίου he would leave uncontested; but these are usually found in *catenae* and thus they alone are guaranteed. Yet even when thus ascribed to S., why are they more probably genuine than much other Coptic literature, falsely attributed to famous names? Again, where the 3rd person is used, can S. himself be speaking? Nor do the troubles and violence referred to in the texts fit with the supposed date; they point more probably to Arab times.

Such and other criticisms it is by no means easy to meet satisfactorily. Internal evidence, style, an accurate dating of the MSS. (certain of which, at any rate, must be themselves pre-Mohammedan) will eventually decide a question for which no traditional ascription alone can suffice.

LEIPOLDT too has reviewed Amélineau's work^{31a} and, with help of the photographs and copies collected with a view to his own edition, has drawn up a considerable list of inaccuracies in the texts printed.

The persistence of Shenoute's homilies in ecclesiastical use is a tribute to the value set upon them. Two at any rate have survived in Arabic translations, and of these one (nominally on the text Jerem. viii, 22 or xlv, 11) is analysed by TISSERANT,³² who finds little in the vague form of the scripture citations or other features to help in deciding as to authenticity. For neither of the Arabic texts has a Coptic original as yet been signalled.

'Eusebius of Alexandria' is still a mysterious person. MORIN discusses the Latin version of a sermon on Sunday observance, attributed to him.³³

F. CÖLN has begun an edition,³⁴ with translation, of the Arabic Nomocanon of Michael of Malig, otherwise known as the 'Spiritual Medicine.' He would date the author (if indeed he be also the compiler of the *Synaxarium*) about 1100, considerably earlier than does Wüstenfeld. The subjects dealt with so far are pride, murder, various forms of immorality, continence, divorce, sorcery &c.

The second part of G. Ph. 'AWAD's annotated edition of the Nomocanon³⁵ of Ibn al-'Assâl (*v. Report* 1905-6, 69) will be issued almost simultaneously with this *Report*. It contains the secular canons, from no. 23 to the end (*v. Mai* iv, p. 284), with the addition of 4 appendices: a chapter from the *Foundations of Religion* by the author's brother, Abû Ishâk; the canonical replies of Cyril b. Laqlak to certain questions by Christodulus of Damietta (*v. Riedel*, p. 302); a poem (*arjûzah*) ascribed to Abû'l-Faraj, another brother, on the law of inheritance; the canons of the above Cyril, taken from a MS. of A.D. 1240, said to be in that patriarch's own hand.

H. LECLERCQ describes and discusses the Coptic texts attributed to the Nicene synod.³⁶ Summing up previous investigations, he decides against their authenticity, at least as any genuine part of the synod's work.

PREUSCHEN reviews Leipoldt's *Didymus* at length.³⁷

5. *History, Legends &c.*—A new study of the beginnings of Arianism, by S. ROGALA,³⁸ is commended by G. Krüger (*Th. Lit. Z.* 1908, 331) for its independent criticism of the sources, as against the views of Seek (*Z. f. Kirchengesch.* 1897).

The Greek MS. Paris 881 was pointed out by Ladeuze as containing an

unknown recension of the Life of Pachomius. This, together with part of another text (Paris 480), is edited by NAU,³⁹ who accompanies it with a translation of the ancient Syriac version. There still remain unpublished the Greek original (the Metaphrast) of Surius's Latin and the quotations of a certain Nikon. The original documents to be assumed are, N. holds, a collection of *Ascetica*, a Life of Pachomius and one of Theodore.

NAU continues his print⁴⁰ of the Greek *Apophthegmata* according to the MS. Coislin 126.

Reviews by Bonwetsch⁴¹ and Turaef⁴² speak favourably of a large Russian work on early Egyptian monasticism by E. TROITSKY, based on first-hand study of the various recensions. He regards the *Paralipomena* as a loose collection of tales, not as an excerpt. He takes the Bohairic Life for the older, whence the Sa'idic was translated! But he concludes of course for the Greek as prior to the Coptic texts.

Note may be taken here of the problem raised by PETRIE's discovery at Memphis of terra-cottas apparently depicting Indians.⁴³ What relation would this evidence of an Indian (Buddhist) colony hold to Asoka's mission westward, in B.C. 260? Might not Buddhist propaganda in Egypt be of influence in the formation of subsequent Christian asceticism?

The important documents recently brought to light regarding the career and doctrines of Nestorius are incidentally affecting the history of Shenoute. BETHUNE BAKER points out⁴⁴ that, since it is now clear (in spite of Evagrius) that N. survived Chalcedon (451) and since S. himself writes of N. as long deceased, therefore S. cannot have died, as hitherto reckoned, in 451. But Leipoldt (on the strength of, it must be owned, a rather obscure statement by Bêsa, S.'s disciple) has given 466 as a possible alternative; this therefore should be the true year of Shenoute's death.

SICKING has of late published various studies in 5th century church history. In the most recent⁴⁵ he examines the accounts of Cyril's accession to the archbishopric, taking a view of the events differing from that of H. von Schubert.

With a double volume (text and Latin translation) by BALESTRI and HYVERNAT⁴⁶ the Paris *Corpus* opens what will be a lengthy series of Coptic *Acta*. The ten texts are all from the Vatican Bohairic collection and thus supersede Zoega's extracts, which were not transcribed from the originals. The Diocletian martyrs, whose histories are given, are Lacaron (not met with in the calendars or elsewhere), Anatolius the Persian, Theodore the Eastern, Sarapion of Panephosi (already *ed.* Balestri), Apa Til, Paphnouti, Epime, Theodore the General, Anoub, Apoli. The importance of having reliable prints of these ancient texts (the MSS.

themselves date from about A.D. 900), as a basis for any study of the northern dialect, cannot be overestimated. MASPERO, in a review,^{46a} refers to a version of the Diocletian legend unknown to me.

A valuable contribution towards Egyptian hagiography is further made by PEREIRA'S publication with translations of seven martyrdoms in their Ethiopic versions.⁴⁷ The group chosen is that of the so-called Diocletian cycle and comprises the stories of Basilides, Justus and his family, Theodore the Eastern, Apa Tîr and Irai, Claudius, Victor, Sisinnius.

That the value however of such texts as these is mainly philological—that history has little to look for from them—cannot be denied and is well expressed by PEETERS, in a review of Pereira's work.⁴⁸

Notes on the various Bohairic hagiographical texts preserved in the Leipzig MSS. are given by CRUM.⁴⁹ The most noticeable fragment is perhaps that narrating a dialogue as to a piece of the Cross, between an 'archbishop' and a *σύμβουλος*, whose words, as well as this title, show him to be a Moslem governor. A review by PEETERS⁵⁰ makes some suggestions.

WINSTEDT prints⁵¹ a fragment from the Sa'idic martyrdom of James the Persian ('Intercisus').

The relations between hagiography and hymnology—how hymns are built upon the *Acta*—are discussed by KRUMBACHER,⁵² in his investigations as to the sources drawn upon by Romanos. R.'s hymn to St. Menas is shown to be based on a lost form of the story, another unpublished version of which is here edited. The difference between these Greek and the Coptic (*Synaxarium*) versions is remarkable.

A further fasciculus of BASSET'S *Synaxarium* (months of Hatûr and Kihak) has appeared.⁵³ It is of much greater interest than its predecessor; for use is now largely made of Paris MS. 4869, the peculiar, evidently Upper Egyptian, recension employed by Amélineau in his *Actes*. A number of narratives are thus given which are wanting in Wüstenfeld and so far in Forget, who however will print them as an appendix to the ordinary recension. A feature of this peculiar MS. is the number of anonymous stories, taken from some form of *Apophthegmata* or *Patericon*.

Those who have worked at the Coptic calendar have long been aware of the peculiar Arabic form of it given by Abû 'l-Barakât, in his 'Lamp of Darkness' (at any rate in the Paris MS.). Not a few commemorations absent from the other available recensions are there recorded, and NAU'S print⁵⁴ of Renaudot's Latin translation of it will be welcome.

In the British Museum Coptic Catalogue (nos. 349, 350) are fragments of a history of Severus of Antioch, entirely different from the Syriac Lives.

The recognition of these passages in the complete Ethiopic version has led to the publication of the latter by E. J. GOODSPEED, together with the Coptic fragments (which include Zoega's no. CLXXXV, hitherto ascribed to Shenoute) by CRUM.⁵⁵ It may here be noted that these 6 Coptic passages correspond to those on pp. 600, 620, 622, 632, 682, 708 of the Ethiopic.

Though not Egyptian saints, Cosmas and Damianus were buried, their story tells, at 'Phereman,' which Deubner, like others, takes to be Faramâ-Peremoun-Pelusium. CRUM has attempted,⁵⁶ on the strength of Coptic and Arabic forms of the name, to invalidate this assumption; but in vain. PEETERS⁵⁷ and (in a letter) NAU have made it probable that the various transcriptions are but misunderstandings of the name as found in the Greek texts and supported too by the Melkite *Menaeon*.

The edition of texts recently published by GIRON (*v. last Report* 71) has been rather severely criticised by LEIPOLDT,⁵⁸ PEETERS,⁵⁹ and DROHME (?)⁶⁰; also by AMÉLINEAU,⁶¹ who narrates a story from the *Synaxarium* to show how such legends were composed purely for purposes of edification.

PEETERS has also written short but critical notices of Leipoldt's *Vita Sinuthii*, Balestri's 'Theodore the Eastern' (*v. last Report* 71) and Crum's 'Baršaumâ'⁶².

A highly interesting account is given by AMÉLINEAU⁶³ of his stay, a few years since, in the midst of one of the most influential Coptic families of to-day: the Battarsi (said to be properly 'Batrassi,' from Peter, their founder's name), resident S. of Girga. Their mode of life is, as A. says, almost feudal, in its extensive and patriarchal character. Their agricultural and commercial operations have attained great development, although the fortunes of the family are but a generation old. Many interesting and curious photographs assist in giving a very lively picture of the actual life of the wealthier Copts.

6. *Non-Literary Texts*.—A *corpus* of Christian inscriptions from Egypt is an ideal often contemplated. Towards its fulfilment, so far as Greek texts are concerned, the large collection (about 800), edited by G. LEFÉBVRE⁶⁴ is a very substantial contribution. A quarter of the texts are of unknown *provenance*, scarcely any bear dates; L. has aimed therefore at classifying them according to style of ornament or the formulae. He sums up his results in instructive chapters on the types of inscription, the abbreviations, monograms, titles, grammatical features &c. Some 95 texts appear to be hitherto unpublished; most of the remainder are from L.'s copies. With the exception of a few stelae at South Kensington, all attainable texts seem to have been gathered. It may be observed that no. 778 is not *inédit* (*v. Report* 1898-99, 61).

Coptic stelae, on the other hand, in so far as they have reached the Cairo Museum since Crum's Catalogue, are edited by BIONDI.⁶⁵ They number over eighty and show many points of interest. Several (nos. 23-27) must be due to the great monastery of Jeremias at Saqqâra. No. 31 is another of the marble stelae with Bohairic text which need special investigation. Those from Aswân (47 &c.) show the formula, peculiar, it seems, to the south: 'God of spirits and of all flesh' (*v. Report* 1904-5, 61).

STEINDORFF publishes the grave-stone of an 11th century bishop, Jêsu, of Zaê (now Saï), in Nubia.⁶⁶ BUDGE had depicted the same stone in his *History of the Soudân*.⁶⁷

TURAEF has collected and edited several interesting texts,⁶⁸ none of which is without obscure points. (1) A 6th-7th century letter; (2) a semi-Achmîmic imprecation (*cf.* that in *Aeg. Z.* xxxiv, 85) the script strongly recalling *Brit. Mus. Catal.*, pl. 12, no. 1224, the form of *gima* being quite peculiar; (3) stele with obscure place-names and (4) another, mentioning a monastic hospital, *cf.* Cairo, no. 8499. VON LEMM has suggested plausible emendations to the first of these.⁶⁹

The British Museum has recently acquired a large number of Greek and Coptic papyri, quite unparalleled in their close relationship of place, date, and persons. All come from Jkôw (now Kôm Ishkaw), which the Greeks called Aphroditô; all date from the years 707-711 or thereabouts and all relate to the same group of persons—the Moslem governor, writing from Fustât, the local officials, pagarch, and village representatives. The corresponding Arabic papyri have already been published by C. H. Becker. This is not the place for enlarging upon the importance of these documents for Byzantine and early Moslem history. The Coptic texts, to be edited by Crum, form the counterpart of the Greek ones, now in course of publication by H. I. Bell; the former consist of the response of the local authorities to the requirements of the central government, as embodied in the Greek and Arabic letters. The collection throws new light upon all sides of Coptic village life—the various burdens in taxes, supply of sailors, artizans &c., the topography, proper-names. Ecclesiastical affairs of course are scarcely illustrated. A preliminary description of the Greek texts, with discussions of many interesting problems, has been given by BELL.⁷⁰

Among the Greek papyri at Strassburg, edited by PREISIGKE,⁷¹ are a set of 6th century deeds of surety, wherein the guarantor undertakes to produce his man where required—but not in the sacred premises, (before) the *θεῖοι χαρακτῆρες* (which P. takes for images of the saints) nor on Sundays or holidays. This would seem to illustrate the church's adoption and extension of the ancient right of asylum.

Six ostraca, from Des Rivières' copies, are published by WINSTEDT;⁷² also a stele, which, to judge by the formula, should belong to the Jeremias monastery.

SAYCE has copied certain *graffiti* at Gebel Silsila, which, if not Coptic, are at any rate Christian.⁷³

Among the texts from Dair Balaizah (v. no. 9 above) is an interesting marriage contract and a good many other legal deeds, relating to the affairs of the monastery.

GALTIER gives⁷⁴ a revised edition of a Fayyûmic letter published by Krall (*Mitth.* v, 52). He also prints and discusses a stele with poetical formulae, dated 765 A.D. (not A.M.).

Makrizi's descriptive catalogue of the churches and monasteries of Egypt is translated by LEROY.⁷⁵

DELAPORTE has printed,^{75a} from a liturgical MS., the list of the first 86 Alexandrine patriarchs, comparing the barbaric spellings with that of Kircher's and Bouriant's lists, and so emphasizing the debased standard of orthography which sufficed these mediæval scribes.

7. *Philological*.—ANDERSSON draws attention⁷⁶ to cases in the *Pistis* where *je-* would seem to mean 'again.' He also⁷⁷ compares the use there of *pa-rmwœin*, referred to the speaker, with that of the ancient *ka* and suffix. But instances such as p. 293, 7 make his explanation at least doubtful. Elsewhere A. examines⁷⁸ the use, in the same text, of the prepositions *oue* and *oube*.

Among the many remarkable features of the new Achmîmic 'Clement,' the use of a prosthetic *ah-* with the relative *et-*, before infinitives, is conspicuous. It is discussed by ERMAN.⁷⁹

RAHLFS classifies⁸⁰ the Coptic negative particles, and points out that they are derived from verbal forms with exactly parallel meanings.

SETHE gives⁸¹ instances of (*e*)*mmon* 'verily,' 'indeed,' already noticed elsewhere (Crum, *Ostr.* no. 83, *Brit. Mus. Cat.* p. 592).

A. JAHN examines⁸² the origin of Coptic *wôm* and concludes that it is from *wn* 'eat,' rather than '*m* 'devour.'

8. *Art, Archaeology, Excavations*.—QUIBELL's account of his Saḳḳâra excavations⁸³ does not deal as yet with the Jeremias monastery: photographs and copies which I have seen promise, however, an unusually rich volume on that site before long. In the meantime we have a description of the Christian burials found among the earlier tombs. The body was laid on the back, facing west, while over face and feet were tied bundles of grass; for grave-clothes, one or two embroidered shirts, with an outer shroud of sacking. No coffins, for the most part, but a palm-leaf mat,

whereon the body lay. We are told, *à propos* of the numerous *Bes* figures in the surrounding tombs, that this god is elsewhere found, even in Christian burials, as an amulet.

Among the primitive graves explored by REISNER⁸⁴ in the cemeteries opposite Girga, numerous shallow Coptic burials were found, cut in among the ancient tombs. The bodies, as at Sakḥâra, lay upon their backs, with head westward.

The excavation of the Menas sanctuary, with its vast dependencies, has now been brought to a close (*v. last Report* 74). C. M. KAUFMANN'S third Report⁸⁵ tells of another (the fourth) basilica, in close relation to spacious guest and waiting rooms and baths of various dimensions, one of some 78 × 45 yards. An elaborate system of lead piping is traceable, for the supply and draining of the healing water and for the heating of the baths. This thermal basilica, assigned to the 5th century, was lined wholly with white marble. Further, the 'coenobia' of dwelling-houses, cellars &c., ascribed to the 5th-9th centuries, were laid bare. The disappointing side of the excavations is in the poor harvest of inscriptions: the name of the patron saint here and there, a few Greek ostraca, including wine accounts and dated by H. I. BELL in the 5th and 6th centuries, some proper names (still to be published) and scraps of inscribed jars, together with an unexpected Latin *graffito*. It is significant of the place and age that Coptic should not be represented. Although K. professes to regard the work done as practically final, it is evident that not a little of the ground remains still to be explored. It is heartily to be desired that health and funds will some day permit him to resume this most important work.

PETRIE'S discovery of extensive brick ruins on the S. side of the 'White Monastery' is an event of considerable importance for the history of Shenoute's community.⁸⁶ Do they represent the primitive settlement of his predecessor, Pgôl? PETRIE argues that, pottery of Constantine's age being found there, the building was pre-monastic: therefore coenobitic. In the middle of the brick enclosure are traces of a stone building, perhaps a church. Noticeable too are the pottery drain-pipes and certain large circular vats. The surrounding brick wall once enclosed the present monastery too. The present confused sequence among the carved stones re-utilized in the latter would point to their origin in these earlier buildings. Five miles S. of Sohâg P. found another brick *dair*, whose recluses seem to have dwelt in and decorated the neighbouring rock tombs.

PETRIE'S preceding volume, dealing with Dair Balaizah, gives photo-

graphs of that building and of a second knife (*v. last Report*, p. 75) and set of large needles; further, of a curious type of stele with *orantes*.⁸⁷

A good general account, with illustrations and texts, of the monastery at Bawît is given by CLÉDAT.⁸⁸ He imagines it to have been destroyed in the second half of the 12th century, and appears ready to identify the name etymologically with *Ebôt* (Abydos) and *wôt* ('same'). CASANOVA, he tells us (adopting Amélineau's suggestion, *Géogr.* 366), proposes to see in Bawît the diocese 'Poubisa,' misread thus from the Arabic.

A lengthy account of the Oasis ruins of Al-Bagawât based on De Bock's work (*v. Report* 1900-01, 76) is given by LECLERCQ.⁸⁹ Of these most interesting ruins we may hope ere long to hear more, from the American expedition which has now definitely taken them in hand.

I may here mention an account, by M. JULLIEN,⁹⁰ of various monasteries, valuable for its photographs, which escaped me at its publication. The buildings described are Sitta Dimyânah, Dair Abû Fanes (*i.e.* Fânah-Bane), D. Ganadla, D. al-Fakûri (*i.e.* Matthew the Poor), D. Rifah, the White Monastery, D. Bablûn at Cairo, Mari Girgis at Achmîm, the Monastery of the 7 Hills W. of Achmîm, D. Anba Bisadah opposite Menshiyah, D. Anba Balamûn at Kasr as-Saiyad, a monastery at Fâu, D. Anba Bachûm N.W. of Luxor.

We may eventually expect detailed descriptions of the numerous Christian cemeteries examined during LYONS'S and REISNER'S 'Survey' of Nubia. In the meanwhile several are mentioned: at Shellal, Taifa and elsewhere.⁹¹ The bodies in one of them were wrapped in coarse shrouds, bound about with tape. In another the graves, in long, regular rows, are surmounted by white structures, in the W. end of which Greek stelae were found inserted.

WEIGALL'S inspection of northern Nubia likewise records observations of various Christian remains⁹²: ruined churches, and monasteries (p. 23, small monks' cells), frescoes in temple (especially p. 139), inscriptions Greek and Coptic. Pl. lxviii has a photograph of a monastery.

Certain archaeologists have difficulty in distinguishing the later pagan from Christian antiquities. WILPERT,⁹³ for instance, has claimed as Christian a mummy with what looks like a rectangular nimbus, while STRZYGOWSKI and MARUCCHI⁹⁴ regard it—certainly rightly—as pagan.

The 2nd part of the sale of RUSTAFJELL'S antiquities⁹⁵ contained 8 Coptic stelae and a fine bronze pendant lamp, with open-work pattern.

BRECCIA shows⁹⁶ a photograph of a fine capital of a column, lately acquired by the Alexandria Museum.

J. BAILLET describes⁹⁷ elaborately the specimens of tapestry from

Antinoë in the Orleans Museum. In many of the designs and motives he recognizes pagan survivals; in all he sees a mystic symbolism. There are numerous plates, giving clever reconstructions of the tattered pieces. SCOTT-MONCRIEFF declines⁹⁸ to see traces of Egyptian paganism in these late classical designs.

A photograph may be here mentioned of a fine linen tunic, with the silk *appliqué* ornaments still in place, in the South Kensington Museum.⁹⁹ In the design figures a mounted saint, 'Zacharias.'

The obscure word *quadrapulus*, found in the *Liber Pontificalis* as the name of a costly textile (8th-9th cent.), is derived by CRUM from the name of *Katrabbul*, near Baghdad.^{99a} A stuff so designated occurs in a Copto-Arabic list of clothing.

9. *Miscellaneous*.—O. VON LEMM has printed¹⁰⁰ a number of short notes, dealing with such a variety of subjects, that, though almost always relating to the literature, they may best be classed here. Among the points discussed we may mention: the biblical quotations of Shenoute; the magical use of a stone dropped into wine to cause strife; the name of 'Berzelia,' the epilepsy demon (cf. 'Alabastria' in Clédat's *Baouit*); the authorship of Brit. Museum *Coptic Catal.* no. 214, which cites Shenoute; the place-name *Hagé* (already in Krall no. cexlii); Brit. Museum *Catal.* no. 217, a highly interesting MS., whereof more fragments have recently come to light, and deserving of special study; the identity of St. Theonoe; numerous emendations to the texts of the Ephesian synod and to various other publications.

The veteran F. ROSSI sketches¹⁰¹ the progress of Egyptian studies as based upon the study of Coptic; while P. MARESTAING reminds us¹⁰² that Athanasius Kircher, though he made no attempt to utilize it, was aware of the importance of Coptic as a key to deciphering the hieroglyphics.

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²⁸ *Die Papyrus-Urkunden von Hermupolis*, in *Deutsche Rundschau*, Oct. 1908.

²⁹ *Lexical notes from the Papyri*, in the *Expositor*, 1908–9.

³⁰ *New Palaeographical Society*, part vii, plates 152, 153.

C.—CHRISTIAN EGYPT.*

1. *Biblical*.—That the vast Rainer collection contains a quantity of valuable Coptic material still unpublished, has long been of common knowledge, and students must congratulate themselves that Krall's efforts to make this gradually available are being so successfully continued by WESSELY. Following on his editions of the Psalter and Fayyûmic fragments, he has now given us a miscellaneous volume,¹ comprising a number of Old Testament texts, both Greek and Coptic. Of the 34 Coptic passages, 12 are wholly new, 6 more partly so. It may be observed that no. 33, which has strayed among the *patristica*, is simply Isaiah v, 11–27. Wessely has added a list of the variants from published bible texts.

One of the finest Sa'idic MSS. in the British Museum must have been, when complete, the papyrus codex (ca. 7th century), from the poor remnants of which SIR HERBERT THOMPSON has succeeded in transcribing large portions of the Salomonic books and Ecclesiasticus.² The new text is of varying merit, but often at least equal to that of Lagarde's print. The introduction contains an interesting description of the material construction ('Faserung') of the volume.

DEIBER prints³ passages from Sa'idic Jeremiah and Lamentations, most of which had been given by Maspero from the same MSS.

WINSTEDT prints 17 Old Test. fragments (Sa'idic) from the British Museum, some of which are new.⁴ One, from Hosea, is remarkable, as

* I again owe some references to Prof. L. Scherman's kindness.

showing a nearer relation to Theodotion than to the LXX. Most variants however, "agree very closely with the LXX MSS. known to have been written in Egypt."

Several of these same fragments were copied by J. SCHLEIFER, who announces an edition of them.⁵

The Sa'idic fragments of St. John's Gospel in the Paris collection—and they comprise the whole, less only some 20 verses—are edited, with all variants in the case of duplicates, by H. GUÉRIN, a small addition being supplied by DELAPORTE.⁶ BALESTRI points out⁷ a number of bad readings, though without assigning responsibility for them to the editors or their MSS.

2. *Apocryphal, Gnostic*.—LIEBLEIN continues his comparisons between the conceptions of the *Pistis Sophia* and Egyptian paganism⁸ (v. last *Report* 63), pointing out the similarity between the prohibitions, *PS.* text, 254 ff., and the 'negative confession' (*Bk. of Dead*, ch. 125). He concludes with a note on the year whereon certain calculations are based (text, 243), and in which, as being of 365 days, he sees the Egyptian, as opposed to the Babylonian or Julian calendar.

ANDERSSON observes⁹ that several of Lieblein's views on these subjects coincide with those already expressed by Amélineau.

In an article upon the gnostic influences in Egyptian Christianity,¹⁰ P. SCOTT-MONCRIEFF analyses the *Pistis*, noting the pagan ideas surviving in it. He approves Amélineau's 9th–10th century date for the MS., though to support it would be palaeographically all but impossible. He draws attention to various pieces of evidence for the syncretistic tendencies of the age, discussing *inter alia* the supposed mortuary chapels and offerings found at Antinoë, and the fish used as an emblem of the soul on a late Egyptian coffin. (This has also attracted the notice of SPIEGELBERG.¹¹) It may be observed that the Deir el-Bahri mummy bore a Greek, not a Coptic, label.

No. 20 of WESSELY's above-mentioned texts is from an Egyptian version of the so-called *Paralipomena Ieremiae* (v. Amélineau, *Contes* ii, esp. p. 102, and in general *PRE.*³, xvi, 262). Fol. 16 of Paris vol. 132¹ is from this MS. and immediately precedes the Vienna leaf.

2. *Liturgical*.—In the last *Report* p. 64 were mentioned important fragments (*ca.* 600) of a Greek anaphora, to be edited by P. DE PUNIER. We now have the edition, with exhaustive commentary.¹² The great importance of the text lies in its testimony to the primitive position (so its editor maintains) of the *epiclesis* in the Egyptian rite: before, not after, the consecration. The creed too is preserved and appears, for the

first time, in its original Egyptian form, much like that of Rome. Its position too, in the mass, is unexpected. From these abnormal features it is concluded that the primitive rite of Egypt was substantially parallel with that of Rome.

VON DER GOLTZ reprints¹³ and discusses these texts, the origin of which he would assign to the 3rd or even 2nd century. He accepts the resemblance claimed with the Roman rite. A sight of the original would dispel his doubts as to all the fragments being from a single MS.

The officially authorized *Euchologion* (v. *Report* 1903-04, 77) has been reedited by M. BISÂDA and CL. LABÎB, in small 'pocket' form.¹⁴ The text consists of Basil, parts of Gregory and of the services for the dominical festivals. A new Introduction treats of the origin of the Coptic language and liturgies, with reference chiefly to the preservation of the former in the latter, as the best aid to-day towards maintaining the individuality of the race. Ecclesiastical decrees are mentioned, later in date at any rate than Al-Hâkim (*ob.* 1021), which enjoined the use of Coptic alone in church service and in the private houses of the faithful. Presumably this is a reference to patriarchal canons among the many which still await investigation. It is strange that the medieval canon law of the neighbouring Syrian churches obtains constant attention, while that of Egypt remains, for the most part, wholly unavailable.

The same Cairo press issued, four years ago, the Funeral Services to-day in use.¹⁵ They differ somewhat in sequence from Brit. Mus. no. 846, still more from Tuki's print.

BAUMSTARK describes¹⁷ and translates the Coptic rite of the Blessing of the Waters at Epiphany (*cf.* Budge's edition, 1901), which he regards as the oldest witness to the early Greek form of this and the baptismal service.

The gradual transformation, since 451, of the Alexandrine liturgy, as used by the Melkite community, into Byzantine form, is traced by C. CHARON.¹⁷ The true Alexandrine rite has been maintained, since the 13th century, by the Copts alone.

A two-panelled ivory diptych, bought in Egypt by Mr. Moir Bryce, is published by CRUM.¹⁸ Its text (Greek) is so far unique, in that it shows, not only the names of living and deceased patriarchs and bishops, but also the preliminary prayer, usually found in the mass book. The names upon it show that it was written between 623 and 662 and revised before 680. The diocese concerned is hard to fix. P. MAAS shows¹⁹ that the editor's attempt to identify the reigning bishop Pesynthius with the well-known Pesynthius of Koptos is chronologically impossible.

EDMUND BISHOP has interesting observations on the meaning here of

εὐχαριστήριον, and on the influence of the Syrian (Jacobite) liturgy of St. James upon the Egyptian Mark.²⁰ He makes it probable moreover that this diptych was intended for the use of some private person, and that its text was independently put together, rather than derived immediately from any liturgy.

An 'orthodox' edition of the *Psalmodia* (*Theotokia*) has been issued at Alexandria.²¹ Its arrangement: the 4 Odes together, then the 7 Theotokias, is that of Tuki's print; but the additional matter is mainly that found in nos. 430, 431 of the Rylands collection, or Brit. Mus. no. 863. One of the pieces (p. 267) is said to be 'according to the rite of Mâr Antonius,' and a saint proper to that monastery is appended to the diptych (p. 87, Mark). Presumably investigation would show local differences in the versions of this book. A useful introduction indicates its liturgical employment.

H. Junker's study of Coptic hymnology (v. last *Report* 63) is minutely criticized by W. WEYH,²² especially as regards the various metrical and musical terms. A review by CRUM²³ adds some illustrations of these and references relative to the legends involved.

GRENFELL AND HUNT'S last volume²⁴ contains a short prayer (5th or 6th century), asking God to say whether the suppliant shall undertake a certain journey. The editors suggest that it was intended for depositing in a church.

L. BARRY prints²⁵ a short prayer, on papyrus, begging God and the angels to strike a woman and her children, as in that published *Aeg. Z.* xxxiv, 85.

MRS. BUTCHER describes²⁶ the curious magic ritual, still or till recently in use, for curing victims of hydrophobia. It consists of a recital of the adventures of St. Tarabo (?) with a mad dog, followed by prayers, lessons, and a pantomime. MSS. of this service, all quite modern, are described in Crum's catalogue of the Rylands collection. With the identification there (p. 236) suggested, Tarabo-Trypho, cf. the interesting article on the latter saint in magical texts, by L. ARNAUD.²⁷

In so far as the magical papyri containing the prayers dealt with by TH. SCHERMANN²⁸ are of Egyptian *provenance*, his investigation of their relations to that in i Ep. Clement, to the LXX and later Jewish phraseology may be mentioned here.

4. *Church Literature*.—Undoubtedly the most important addition to our material this year is the body of Sinuthian texts excellently edited by LEIPOLDT and WESSELY respectively. L.'s volume,²⁹ the first of several to come, gives us 233 pp. of text, comprising some 50 distinct pieces, 34 of

which are new. The texts can scarcely be characterized in general, except in so far as they exclude the strictly monastic works, *i.e.* those in the form of or involving monastic rules and admonitions. We have a series of epistles to magistrates, with their replies (in what language did these Byzantine officials address the Coptic abbot?), correspondence with Alexandrian patriarchs, letters to clergy, to ill-conducted nuns (no. 7), to pagan philosophers; sermons dogmatical, with attacks on historical doctrines current presumably in the district (nos. 14, 17), narrative (often with interesting historical *data*), and exegetical (p. 52 ff., on the Song of Songs). Now and then the text disappoints expectations raised by its title: *e.g.* from no. 32 we learn nothing as to Pgôl, Shenoute's obscure predecessor. An exhaustive index to all Greek words, by MICHAELANGELO GUIDI, closes the volume. An attempt at palaeographical estimates and datings will be made by the present writer in a subsequent volume.

One of the features of WESSELY's contribution³⁰ is the facsimile which accompanies each text (?except no. 43), thus allowing of relationships with other fragments being fixed forthwith. Making use sometimes of Krall's copies, W. has transcribed 24 texts (87 pp.); but he abstains from attributing all to Shenoute. No. 37, for instance, apparently part of Brit. Mus. no. 175, would not be his. Perhaps the most interesting numbers are 41 (= Brit. Mus. 204 &c.) directed against Origen and the Stoics, and 42 (= Brit. Mus. 231) against various gnostic notions (the existence of 12 gospels, 40 aeons), heretical objections (the absence from the bible of the word *ὁμοούσιος*), and magical practices (42b = Paris 129¹⁴, 66, a very curious passage). The allusion too in no. 48 to the treatment and the *ὑπομνήματα* of the martyrs is noteworthy. No. 49 is a duplicate of Leipoldt's p. 136 ff.

The untimely death of E. GALTIER will be felt by all interested in Christian Egypt. A note by him³¹ calls attention to the Arabic version of a Sinuthian homily: it is that recently analysed by Tisserant (*v. last Report* 66). Chassinat announces his intention of publishing a selection of Galtier's notes and transcripts.

In studying the Bobbio palimpsests, J. BICK has deciphered³² remnants of an apostolic *Epistola*, and recognized therein a Latin version of the Achmîmic text which C. SCHMIDT, who, with Lacau, is about to edit it, had (Berlin *Sitzb.* 1895, 705) been unable to identify. In this epistle S. now recognizes one referred to by Origen, and would locate it in Asia Minor. Its author is influenced by the fourth Gospel and by Ignatius. It witnesses moreover to that 'panchristism' prominent in the apocryphal Acts, but here evident in a text unquestionably catholic.

The epistle of Dionysius of Alexandria to Paul of Samosata (*PG.* 28, 1561) is recognized as spurious. BONWETSCH³³ substantiates this view by pointing out that its writer assumes the Nicene arrangements as already triumphant. He would assign it to some Apollinarist opponent of Nestorianism, previous to 451.

V. HUGGER reexamines the chronological sequence of the encyclical epistles of Alexander, the predecessor of Athanasius,³⁴ criticising that proposed by Rogala (*v. last Report* 66). His conclusion is that nos. ii and iii (Migne) belong together and preceded i. He is mistaken in holding Colluthus a rare name (p. 77). Outside the Delta at all events it is one of the commonest.

SICKENBERGER edits, from catenae, some fragments of Cyril's homilies on St. Luke, supplementary to Mai's texts.³⁵ In these homilies the preacher appears to him far to outweigh the exegete.

In his study of the Christology of Timothy Aelurus,³⁶ J. LEBON has the advantage of his predecessors, for he draws upon the actual writings of T., preserved in a Syriac MS. written within a century after his death. He concludes that T. merely followed the lines indicated by his teacher, Cyril, and did not materially deviate from the church's tradition. It might be of interest to know how the Syriac texts compare with those in Ethiopic (Paris, no. 113).

NAU, in criticising Lebon's study,³⁷ agrees that Jacobites of that day objected to Chalcedon because they held it a return to Nestorianism. He would prefer the term 'diplophysite' to 'monophysite,' thus clearly distinguishing them from the Eutychians.

The chief value of the recently printed Armenian version of certain of this Timothy's works³⁸ lies, I am told, in the numerous citations from earlier writers, both orthodox and heretical, among them several from Dionysius of Alexandria, about to be translated by Conybeare.

Several short Greek homilies are edited and discussed by NAU.³⁹ They relate to the observance of Sunday and are sometimes found attributed to 'Eusebius of Alexandria' (*v. last Report* 66). N. supposes 'Eusebius' to be an imaginary name attached to a collection of instructions, a sort of *didascalia*, to which a semi-biographical form was given.

Among the texts edited by L. BARRY⁴⁰ are two leaves showing a kind of paraphrase (Greek) of Joh. xv, 1 and Mat. xxvi, 26.

5. *History, Legends &c.*—The last *Oxyrhynchus* volume contains the first known fragment of the Greek Acts (not Martyrdom) of St. Peter.⁴¹ It appears to agree pretty closely with the Latin version, especially in the shorter form of that.

The same volume gives us a passage from the Acts of St. John,⁴² with incidents otherwise unknown, but probably indicating an early part of that work.

Further, from this volume, a fragment of an unidentified martyrdom,⁴³ wherein the ἡγεμών bids the chief huntsman bring in the martyr, who, the crowd declares, is not a magician.

The Rustafjaell MSS. in the British Museum have supplied C. SCHMIDT with a small addition to his *Acta Pauli*.⁴⁴ The fragment belongs to the Heidelberg MS. and corresponds to pp. 257–60 of Lipsius' Greek text.

S. GASELEE publishes a Cambridge MS. with a fragment of the Bohairic martyrdom of St. Luke.⁴⁵ NAU points out its identity, almost verbal, with the text printed by Balestri (*v. Report* 1904–05, 78).⁴⁶ The high page-number of the leaf, 788, is remarkable.

The history of Menas again occupies a good deal of attention. His publication of the invaluable Nubian MS. in the British Museum has given BUDGE occasion to edit and translate two Ethiopic versions of the martyrdom:⁴⁷ one that known already, from the *Synaxarium*, the other and longer taken from a martyrology, differing not only in length from the former. This longer version is also described by M. CHAINE,⁴⁸ who seeks to identify in it the central crypt laid bare by Kaufmann's excavations. He refers to the oil used by the sick at the shrine, but says nothing of the new archaeological evidence for the healing medium being water.

Whatever the foundation for a primitive tradition regarding a Libyan saint (? identical with the martyr) of this name, P. F. DE' CAVALIERI has shown that the story, as we know it, is but an adaptation of the Passion of Gordius of Caesarea, related by Basil, who had conversed with eye-witnesses of his death.⁴⁹

The above mentioned Nubian text, facsimiled in Budge's volume, was, from an incidental illustration, clearly to be referred to St. Menas. With extraordinary skill an all but complete translation of it has been achieved by GRIFFITH,⁵⁰ with nothing to aid him beyond the remaining Nubian fragments (at Berlin) and such literature as can be had relating to the modern idiom. The subject of the text is a miracle concerning a barren woman and an egg, wholly different from those related elsewhere.

One of Rome's suburban churches conceals, under the name of S. Passera, that of the Alexandrine Abba Cyrus (Abû Kîr). Starting hence, P. SINTHERN examines the story of Cyrus and John,⁵¹ whose legend depends solely upon two homilies of Cyril, cited by Sophronius. Their rôle as physicians is explained as simply due to words of Cyril

misunderstood. The name Cyrus is compared with the title *κυρά*, borne by the goddess at Menuthis whom he supplanted. The Roman chapel S. imagines set up by Alexandrine immigrants over against that of Menas, so as to recall the view seen when approaching Alexandria.

WINSTEDT, who intends to edit all the unpublished Woide MSS. in the Bodleian, begins with the martyrdom of Abraham⁵² (*Clar. Press* 48). Were the text not so meagre, we might be able to verify the suspicion that this is none but the biblical patriarch, cast into the furnace by Nimrod (elsewhere Bosoch, *J. Th. St.* x, 463). Here however the king is called Sapor.

The valuable Bohairic martyrdoms, edited by Balestri and Hyvernât (*v. last Report* 67), are reviewed by CRUM, with some comments and emendations.⁵³

From the remarkable Coptic version of Epiphanius *De Gemmis*, WINSTEDT translates⁵⁴ a strange passage as to an isle in the Red Sea, 'the Emerald Isle,' which Roman emperors used to irrigate with oil. He also discusses the historical possibilities of the Egyptian Diocletian legend, seeking to identify the events in which it might have originated.

Availing himself of Lemm's copies, WINSTEDT has considerably added to the fragments of the collection of short, sometimes apocryphal, lives of biblical personages, some of which he has already edited⁵⁵ (*v. last Report* 63). There is perhaps evidence among them for a lost 'Testament of Joshua.' Paris 131⁵, 72 ff., referred to by W. (p. 390), contains short homilies upon Christ and the Virgin.

We may mention here an article by S. ISSLEIB,⁵⁶ in which the series of birth scenes, in the temple of Amenophis iii at Luxor, are compared with the narrative of the annunciation, birth, and divine recognition of Jesus. 'Son of God,' it is observed, is no Jewish royal title, but clearly foreign. Further, in Egyptian myth the highest god and his son, the king, are not found united as one person. These facts must have been known (?) to Arius and Athanasius.

NAU continues his edition of the Greek *Apophthegmata*.⁵⁷ An edition of the Moscow MSS., wherein the collection is arranged as in the Coptic version, is, O. von Lemm informs us, in preparation by P. NIKITIN.

The relationship between the Life of Posthumius (*Vitae Patr.* i) and that of Pachomius—whether the former is but a variant of the latter—appears not to have been as yet investigated. G. ANTOLIN has been able to add a passage to the Life from a Spanish MS.⁵⁸

Two writers are concerned with the Preface to Athanasius' *Festal Letters*. LOOFS⁵⁹ discusses the true interpretation of the 'year' there used

and concludes (against E. Schwartz) that the consular, not the Egyptian, year is intended.

L. CONTARELLI⁶⁰ sees in the *ἡγεμών* here no longer the prefect of Egypt (E. Schwartz), but only the governor of Alexandria and its district.

Though various documents relating to the patriarch Dioscorus have been published, the monograph of F. HAASE is the first independent study of his history.⁶¹ His main source is the Life best preserved in a Syriac version (*v. Report* 1902-03, 58). This, after weighing the arguments—chronological chiefly—brought against it, he considers genuine, the 'Panegyric on Macarius' being derived from it and of no historic value. After the sources, H. discusses the light cast by them upon monophysite manipulation of historical facts; the rôle of Alexandria in the church history of the time; the political talents of Dioscorus; the relation between Egyptian religious feeling and the Chalcedonian formula; the supposed (H. thinks probably historical) conference between emperor and patriarch; the latter's christological position, which, though monophysite in embryo, was far outdistanced by subsequent theology. It is of interest at present (*v. last Report* 67), to note that H. draws attention to the confirmation in the Syriac Life (Nau, 241-2) of the earlier date for Shenoute's death: both he and Nestorius are regarded as dead before 450. Reviewed by LEIPOLDT,⁶² who agrees with Haase's estimates as to the relative value of the sources.

BOLOTOF'S (posthumous) study of the emperor Heraclius is described in the *Byzant. Zeitschrift*.⁶³ He suggests new etymologies for the title 'mukaukas' (*v. Report* 1900-01, 72): it is the Arab name of a black and white bird, which recalled in colour the new patriarch's *omophorion*; or it may be 'κεκαυκασιωμένος, Caucasian savage.'

R. GRIVEAU gives an account⁶⁴ of a curious legend preserved in Arabic,—not, he thinks, devoid of some foundation—as to the wholesale conversion to Christianity of the Jewish inhabitants of Tomai in the Delta (? Temai 'l-Amdîd), in A.D. 631. The instruments of conversion are monks from the Antonius monastery at Kulzûm. The principal convert in time becomes bishop of his native town, and this story is ordered by the patriarch to be read thrice yearly in all churches.

His edition of the Life of St. Tychon gave USENER occasion to discuss afresh the personality and writings of its author, John the Almoner.⁶⁵

LOPAREV laments the inadequacy of our episcopal catalogues of the eastern churches.⁶⁶ The *Acta Sanctorum* now and then bring up an otherwise unknown name, *e.g.* 'Philip bishop of Alexandria,' mentioned in the history of St. Eugenia. Another instance is the Athanasius, obscurely

named in the Life of Paul in *Monte Latro* (ed. Delehaye). Apparently he was, for a time, melkite patriarch of Alexandria, during the reign of Michael ii. L. puts his stay there from 817 to 825; but Eutychius (ii, 411) ignores him, nor is there other evidence of an intruder between the patriarchs Eustathius and Christopher. L. then enumerates the homilies which, since they cannot be claimed for Athanasius i, he proposes to assign to this namesake; among them, the *Synops. Sanct. Script.* and *De Imagin.* (PG. 28, 709). He discusses at length the *De Imagin. Beryti*. What of the 'Canons,' found in certain Athos MSS. ? (Sp. Lambros, Catal., no. 4502).

A new life of Cyril Lukar, by CHR. PAPADOUPOLOS, is chiefly concerned to defend that patriarch's orthodoxy.⁶⁷

Turning to collective works, the foremost to record is the continuation (part 3) of FORGET'S *Synaxarium*⁶⁸; for this consists exclusively of the supplementary and alternative texts contained in the singular Paris MS., which Basset however utilizes concurrently with the usual recension (*v. last Report* 68). The two editions have now given us enough to allow of locating this highly interesting recension. Danfik is 'in our country' (17 Hathor), Denderah (3 Amshir) and Keft (21 Kihak) are near to 'our country,' which is to be sought therefore somewhere to the north of Thebes. As to the date of the redaction, it may be noted that a post-muslim incident occurs on p. 366. Some of the stories, as in Basset's volume, are of great length, *e.g.* Hilaria (p. 384), Sophia (narrated by Chrysostom, 391), Protonike (399), Phoebammon (420), Paul the Hermit (442). Some (as again in Basset) have a narrator named Victor (373, *v.* Basset 361). Sometimes a sermon does duty for a narrative (pp. 372, 383). Among the pieces most important for local history is the short story of Pshoi or Peter (5 Amshir; *cf.* the quite different version, *J. Th. St.* v, 132), the friend of Pgôl, Shenoute and John the Dwarf (*sic*).

PEETERS proposes certain emendations to the text of Basset's *Synaxarium*, and many more to Renaudot's version of Abû 'l-Barakât's Calendar⁶⁹ (*v. last Report* 68).

A highly important 13th century MS. is described by BROCKELMANN⁷⁰: the recension of the Patriarchal History which, B. holds, served Severus as his immediate model. It extends to A.D. 767 and contains various pieces either not given by Severus or given in different form, *e.g.* the Life of Peter i. Smaller additions by the scribe are often referred to MSS. at D. Abû Makâr. B. has collated the text with the edition of Seybold, who, I learn, has been invited to edit this MS. independently. B. does not record the fact that a copy of this text was that used by J. F. Rehkopf for his *Vitae Patriarch. Alexandr.* (1758).

In this connection it may be mentioned that BROCKELMANN had previously noticed ⁷¹ a fragment of a similar Christian history at Breslau, describing it as a source of Makrizi's account of the Copts. It relates to the reign of Heraclius.

6. *Non-literary Texts*.—Fl. Petrie's volume on his work at Memphis contains a supplementary chapter by H. WALKER, on the Coptic objects (ivory, bronze) from Athribis, and stelae from Balaizah, illustrated with 4 plates.⁷² Nos. 7, 14 and 16 among the latter invoke, besides Apollo, a group of saints—Peter, John, Pꝓl (and ? Shenoute, no. 7, l. 15)—whom one may probably connect with the four named together, as above mentioned, in the *Synaxarium*. Three place-names occur on these stelae: Panaho (presumably not the Delta town), Touhō neswo, and Hagé. HERBERT THOMPSON is cited as pointing out that the strange use of 'his brother' in these (and other) inscriptions had acquired simply the meaning 'monk.'

LEFEBVRE publishes ⁷³ inscriptions from Antinoe and El-Bagawât, supplementary to those in his *Recueil*. Two quote Luke xxiii, 42, others invoke the God of Colluthus or of Thecla, the former of these being the patron saint of Antinoe, the latter more probably her of the 8th Kihak than the companion of St. Paul.

WEIGALL facsimiles ⁷⁴ a Greek stele from Kalabsheh, which bears the usual formula, '... rest her soul in the bosom of Abraham &c.'

An article by the late A. PELLEGRINI ⁷⁵ gives the texts of some Greek and Coptic stelae at Florence, apparently not all included in Lefebvre.

DE RICCI describes ⁷⁶ a Greek stele, showing however one of the peculiar Nubian letters in the proper name. The formula is one familiar on the upper Nile (*v. Report* 1904-05, 75 *infra*). It is of the year A.D. 1181, and so, De R. says, the latest dated Greek inscription from Egypt. None of those bearing the same formula are, in his view, earlier than the 10th century.

Two texts from Philae in Lefebvre's *Recueil* (596, 597) are examined by D. SERRUYS,⁷⁷ who shows that they bear no absolute dates, merely naming the Indiction, which is here termed 'the new Indiction,' the designation of the 15 years' cycle which, it seems, succeeded an earlier one of 14 years.

Kaufmann's Menas excavations have produced a series of Greek ostraka, which are edited by E. DRERUP.⁷⁸ They relate to the wine vintage and payment of the labourers. The vines belonged to the monastery and the industry was evidently a considerable one. I should be inclined to assign the ostraka to the 7th century, at earliest, rather than to the 6th.

The fragment of a Greek ostrakon from Medinet Habou, printed by

DE RICCI,⁷⁹ perhaps addresses an Abba Ezekiel; but too little remains to make even this certain.

A 6th century letter from Oxyrhynchus⁸⁰ refers to the μαρτύριον of St. Justus. The well-known martyr of that name suffered at Antinoë (*Synax.*, 10 Amshir).

A joint report, by C. H. BECKER, H. SCHÄFER, and C. SCHMIDT, has been presented to the Berlin Academy,⁸¹ descriptive of the new 10th century Nubian and Arabic documents, which the Museum has acquired. It is intended, I understand, to edit these in conjunction with the Coptic leathern deeds preserved in the British Museum (Catal., no. 447 ff.).

7. *Philological*.—The material for the study of the Achmîmic dialect has been much increased of late years, and though not all of it is yet in print, it appears all to have been studied by F. RÖSCH,⁸² who gives us a grammatical sketch, for which the title, 'Preliminary Observations,' is too modest. He deals minutely with phonetics and accidence, illustrating every rule by plentiful examples. The 'late Achmîmic' texts, such as the *Acta Pauli*, belong, he holds, to the period when the ancient dialect was giving place to the Sa'idic. The former would be at its zenith about the 3rd century, the latter about the 4th—somewhat later, I should have said. Sa'idic R. regards rather as a strictly local development of its predecessor, than as an invading idiom from without. We look forward to R.'s promised edition of the Strassburg 'Clement.'

C. Schmidt's Achmîmic 'Clement' (v. last *Report* 64) shows the curious nasalized forms, *mounte*, *nounte* (so too Brit. Mus. no. 1224). H. RANKE suggests that this may be an attempt at representing a *d* sound (*noude*), or it may be the result of the long vowel preceding.⁸³ V. below, on O. von Lemm.

The problem as to the original language of the *Apophthegmata Patrum* seems still to be unsettled (in spite of E. C. Butler, *Laus. Hist.* i, 284). As a help towards decision, A. LEVY has undertaken an exhaustive statistical examination of the syntax of Zoega's text and has arrived at several interesting results.⁸⁴ One cannot however but be suspicious of a text, the scribe whereof is patently careless and ignorant; see, for instance, the observations (§ 69 ff.) on confusions between perfect and present. If original Coptic there be in the text, one might perhaps expect it in the stories relating to Bané and his friends.

Three obscure passages in the *Apophthegmata* are emended by SETHE,⁸⁵ whose suggestions prove to be in each case confirmed by the reading of the MS.

P. LACAU has studied⁸⁶ the development of the Sa'idic plurals in -owe,

normally belonging to sing. in -ó, but also to those in -é. The true plur. of this latter group is shown, from Achmîmic forms, to be in -ewe. Further, the plurals in -é are properly collectives, in fem. sing., and this can be traced in the ancient language likewise.

SPIEGELBERG discusses⁸⁷ three points of grammar and etymology, among them, an instance of *he*, meaning (as Zoega had suspected) *abortum facere*. But if we read ε- for ḥ here, it seems unnecessary to assume this new meaning.

A. GARDINER shows⁸⁸ that the negative *mpe-* is composed of a verb *p'(w)*, indicating past action, and the particle *bw*.

F. VON CALICE would derive imperative *anine* from 'eni-nai 'bring me.' The parallel *ariré* might be formed on analogy.⁸⁹

ANDERSSON claims priority in recognition of a meaning 'again' for *je-* (*v. last Report* 71), which Spiegelberg has since noticed.⁹⁰

The date to which the Cambyzes story (*v. Report* 1899-1900, 55) should be assigned is still uncertain. SPIEGELBERG⁹¹ would bring it down to muslim times, on the ground that two of its names can best be explained as Arabic: 'Sanouth' = *sanût* 'milk-sop' (a suggestion of SETHE'S), and 'Bothor' = *Bu'tor* = Victor.

In his publication of the Rylands demotic papyri, GRIFFITH⁹² devotes an instructive section to the examination of the Greek and Coptic evidence for pronunciation in the latest pagan periods. The month-names give the fullest results, but a large number of proper names and words are also investigated. The Coptic dialects are distinctly traceable in the later demotic texts.

M. GUIDI and J. PSICHARI are, it is said,⁹³ occupied (? conjointly) in the investigation of the Greek element in Coptic. No branch of Coptic studies is more in need of exploration.

8. *Art, Archaeology, Excavations*.—Some years ago Maspero proposed to see in the ruins at Ras el-Gizr, near Sakkarah, the site of the monastery of St. Jeremias, the existence of which was independently known from documents. QUIBELL'S excavations⁹⁴ have shown that the monastery was very extensive and profusely, if not richly, decorated. Five cells and an adjacent chapel have been laid bare. A Greek graffito is dated by Grenfell in the 8th century. The frescoes are similar, in general style, to those at Bawît; the wall decoration frequently aims at representing tapestry (*e.g.* pl. lviii). Among the saints represented or invoked, Apollo and Enoch are as usual conspicuous. The portrait of the founder, Jeremias (pl. lx), is unusually life-like, and if the square nimbus indicates an actually contemporary likeness, we should have here an important piece

of chronological evidence. But it may be doubted whether the dark square here is to be classed as a nimbus. There has been a large harvest of inscriptions, mostly reserved for subsequent publication; but so far, no manuscripts. The dialect represented is a pure Sa'idic, a fact which inclines one to doubt whether the well-known passports from this monastery (*Aeg. Z.* 1885, 145) really can claim to represent anything but an illiterate Sa'idic jargon.

MASPERO, in a general description of these ruins,⁹⁵ would put the earliest remains, *e.g.* the carved capitals, in the first half of the 5th century.

Of the convents once numerous about Siût, little, CLÉDAT tells us,⁹⁶ now remains; some have been quite lately (1903) destroyed. He reproduces several short inscriptions, among them a list of saints and martyrs and another giving short accounts of the evangelists. He also publishes 17 stelae from the monastery of Simeon at Aswân, which range in date from 724 to 819.

BRECCIA describes⁹⁷ the Christian catacombs at Hadra, an eastern suburb of Alexandria. There are 34 rock-cut graves, disposed round the gallery. Each consists of a vertical well leading into the horizontal grave. Apparently a chapel occupied the centre of the whole. Rough crosses and a few graffiti are visible.

LEFEBVRE mentions⁹⁸ a rock-cut church (?) at Khawaled, S. of Siût, showing three roughly hewn niches, side by side.

BEADNELL'S book upon the Oasis of Khargah⁹⁹ contains photographs (pp. 103, 104) of the great necropolis of El-Bagawât and of one of its frescoed tombs, the same which De Bock's *Matériaux* (pll. xiii, xiv) show.

T. SMOLENSKI has visited the monastery of Kalamûn,¹⁰⁰ which he locates S. of the Wady Rayân and W. of Sedment. He speaks of remarkable church ruins still to be seen. The old MSS. in the library had but recently been sent elsewhere.

The excavations at the Menas shrine are ended and KAUFMANN has published a small guide-book to the site.¹⁰¹ From the extent of the ruins, he would estimate the staff of resident clergy and monks at over a hundred, the inhabitants of the adjacent town at several thousands. On p. 52 a fragment of inscription is given, which seems to name the emperor Valens and which K. dates in 374 or thereabouts—an important fixed point, if so.

AYRTON'S excavations at Abydos¹⁰² have produced but one Coptic monument: a stele (now at Oxford) somewhat of the type of Cairo no. 8710 and, like it, inscribed on both faces. It may date from the 7th or 8th century.

MASPERO describes¹⁰³ a fine bronze censer at Cairo, probably brought

from the White Monastery. He ascribes it to the 14th century at earliest. If so, the inscription in Bohairic is not abnormal. I should think, from the style of lettering, that an earlier date might be defended. Around the bowl are New Testament scenes. Instead of that described as Constantine and Helena at Jerusalem, I would suggest the angel and women at the tomb.

JEAN MASPERO describes¹⁰⁴ certain small bracelets, in silver or bronze, ornamented with medallions which show perhaps gnostic influence, and inscribed with Ps. xc (xci), 1. Some at least are of Egyptian origin. They have presumably protective virtue and may belong to the 7th century.

F. WITTE describes 3 pieces of Egyptian embroidery¹⁰⁵ and suggests interpretations of their designs. The first is as likely to represent a martyr among lions, attended by crown-bearing angels, as Daniel.

Dom Cabrol's Dictionary contains a long article by H. LECLERCQ¹⁰⁶ upon the Christian monuments of Old Cairo. All available material is utilized and amply illustrated. The most instructive paragraphs are perhaps those treating of the decadence of Byzantine art, as exhibited in 'Coptic' sculpture.

LEROY continues his translation of Makrizi's *Churches and Monasteries*, suggesting some variations from that of Evetts.¹⁰⁷

In the designs (especially in embroidery) ornamenting certain of the mummies from Antinoe, E. GUIMET recognizes an eclectic combination of pagan and Christian symbolism.¹⁰⁸ Even in a depiction of Apollo and Daphne he sees emblems of the Resurrection, while the *cruz ansata* may indicate either cult.

Nubia continues to draw away the attention of archaeologists from Egypt itself; but so far the plentiful Christian remains have been but scantily described.¹⁰⁹ Christian burials, of the type called the 'X group,' are met with on all sides, and are assigned to the 2nd-6th centuries. S. of Gerf Hussein, the Christian graves again have superstructures; at Kosh-tamneh they are oriented to the west. Ethnologically the Christian cemeteries show a type identical with the modern inhabitants, though some bodies from the earlier periods point to foreign immigration.

An important discovery was made by SAYCE¹¹⁰ at Sennar, 200 m. S. of Khartum, where Christianity had hitherto not been traced. Among pottery of the 7th-8th century, he came upon the unmistakable symbols—cross, fish, and palm leaves.

9. *Miscellaneous*.—Here we again place O. VON LEMM's valuable contributions, dealing as they do with such a variety of subjects. Among his *Studies*,¹¹¹ no. li consists of notes and identification regarding Leipoldt's

Leipzig MSS. (*v. Reports* 1905-06, 77, 1907-08, 68); no. liii gives us a considerable fragment of an Encomium(?) on Chrysostom in exile, comparable in tone and character to those on Athanasius and Dioscorus; no. lv is a useful list of the abundant biblical citations in the writings of Horsiêse (Lemm promises some day to give us his collection of citations similarly gathered—a very valuable contribution towards the Coptic bible text). Among his 20 new *Miscellanea*,¹¹² no. 1 contains further emendations to Turaiev's texts (*v. Report* 1907-08, 70). It may be observed, however, that the Achmimic charm is directed against two women and a man: Prestasia (Prostasia, *cf.* Lefebvre no. 255), Tnounte (*v.* H. Ranke, *above* and *Brit. Mus. Cat.* no. 1223), and Afôn (Epônnychos). Enoch too is surely but another person included in the curse. No. li is a fragment of a new Peter apocalypse; no. liii deals with a list of Alexander's companions, possibly used as an amulet; no. lxvi examines *Brit. Mus.* no. 254 and *Paris vol.* 78, f. 58-61, two copies of a text in praise of virginity with certain resemblances to the Athanasian *De Virginitate*. These Paris leaves I suspect to form part of the highly interesting but anonymous MS. Zoega cexlv.

A review of some of the above by ANDERSSON¹¹³ consists of lengthy reproductions of Lemm's views and criticisms.

The contents of the Rustafjaell Sa'idic MSS., acquired by the British Museum (*v. Report* 1906-07, 72) are enumerated by DE RICCI,¹¹⁴ who transcribes the list made for their former owner by Lacau and Crum. One MS. (now Or. 6799) was there stated by Crum to be by a Nubian scribe. This was an error: the Nubian name is that of the donor.

A supplement to the Christian portion of the Paris catalogue of Arabic MSS. has been begun by R. GRIVEAU.¹¹⁵ It contains many hagiographical texts relating to Egypt.

The second part of HYVERNAT'S article on *Egypt*, in the *Catholic Encyclopedia*,¹¹⁶ is devoted to the Coptic church, treating rather of its organization than its history. He concludes for the genuineness of the tradition as to the early presbyteral election of the Alexandrine bishop, with whose hegemony in ecclesiastical government he compares the centralized form of the Roman rule in Egypt. One of the best sections is that on the liturgy and liturgical books. It may be observed that the Hippolytan Canons, referred to on p. 359, are in reality nothing but the otherwise well known 'Gnomes' of Nicaea (*v. J. Th. Stud.* ii, 129 n.).

Lord Crawford's collection of Coptic MSS., so long known as among the richest in Europe, passed, eight years since, into the possession of the late Mrs. Rylands and is now deposited in Manchester. A descriptive

catalogue of its 467 MSS. has been prepared by the present writer.¹¹⁷ Interesting as is the literature—biblical, liturgical, homiletic, narrative—the student will probably be first attracted to the private documents, almost 300 in number, among which are a series of 4th and 5th century letters, unquestionably the earliest of such texts hitherto discovered.

Evidence for the continuance of the annual Coptic pilgrimage to the Holy Land is given by a photograph of some of the pilgrims bathing in Jordan.¹¹⁸

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